

Recommendation for Space Data System Standards

AOS SPACE DATA LINK PROTOCOL

RECOMMENDED STANDARD

CCSDS 732.0-B-5

BLUE BOOK
October 2025

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- Space and Upper Atmosphere Research Commission (SUPARCO)/Pakistan.
- Swedish Space Corporation (SSC)/Sweden.
- Swiss Space Office (SSO)/Switzerland.
- United States Geological Survey (USGS)/USA.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document	Title	Date	Status
CCSDS 732.0-B-1	AOS Space Data Link Protocol, Issue 1	September 2003	Original issue, superseded
CCSDS 732.0-B-2	AOS Space Data Link Protocol, Recommended Standard, Issue 2	July 2006	Issue 2, superseded
CCSDS 732.0-B-3	AOS Space Data Link Protocol, Recommended Standard, Issue 3	September 2015	Issue 3, superseded
CCSDS 732.0-B-4	AOS Space Data Link Protocol, Recommended Standard, Issue 4	October 2021	Issue 4, superseded
CCSDS 732.0-B-5	AOS Space Data Link Protocol, Recommended Standard, Issue 5	October 2025	Extends the SCID field in the Transfer Frame primary header to 10 bits and the First Header Pointer in the M_PDU header to 16 bits to accommodate frames up to 65,536 octets in length.
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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 PURPOSE

The purpose of this Recommended Standard is to specify the Advanced Orbiting Systems (AOS) Space Data Link Protocol. This protocol is a Data Link Layer protocol (see reference [1]) to be used over space-to-ground, ground-to-space, or space-to-space communications links by space missions.

1.2 SCOPE

This Recommended Standard defines the AOS Space Data Link Protocol in terms of:

- a) the services provided to the users of this protocol;
- b) the protocol data units employed by the protocol; and
- c) the procedures performed by the protocol.

It does not specify:

- a) individual implementations or products;
- b) the implementation of service interfaces within real systems;
- c) the methods or technologies required to perform the procedures; or
- d) the management activities required to configure and control the protocol.

1.3 APPLICABILITY

This Recommended Standard applies to the creation of Agency standards and to future data communications over space links between Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems (CCSDS) Agencies in cross-support situations. The Recommended Standard includes comprehensive specification of the services and protocol for inter-Agency cross support. It is neither a specification of, nor a design for, the real systems that may be implemented for existing or future missions.

The Recommended Standard specified in this document is to be invoked through the normal standards programs of each CCSDS Agency and is applicable to those missions for which cross support is anticipated based on capabilities described in this Recommended Standard. Where An AOS Transfer Frame shall encompass the major fields capabilities are clearly indicated in sections of the Recommended Standard, they must be implemented when this document is used as a basis for cross support. Where options are allowed or implied, implementation of these options is subject to specific bilateral cross support agreements between the Agencies involved.

1.4 RATIONALE

The CCSDS believes it is important to document the rationale underlying the recommendations chosen, so that future evaluations of proposed changes or improvements will not lose sight of previous decisions.

1.5 DOCUMENT STRUCTURE

This document is divided into six numbered sections and three annexes:

- a) section 1 presents the purpose, scope, applicability, and rationale of this Recommended Standard and lists the conventions, definitions, and references used throughout the Recommended Standard;
- b) section 2 provides an overview of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol;
- c) section 3 defines the services provided by the protocol entity;
- d) section 4 specifies the protocol data units and procedures employed by the protocol entity;
- e) section 5 specifies the managed parameters used by the protocol entity;
- f) section 6 specifies the protocol entity with support for the Space Data Link Security Protocol;
- g) annex A is the Protocol Implementation Conformance Statement (PICS) proforma for the specifications contained in this Recommended Standard;
- h) annex B lists all acronyms used within this document;
- i) annex C provides a list of informative references;
- j) annex D contains informative implementation examples of how to randomize the Transfer Frame Data Field of an Only Idle Data (OID) Transfer Frame.

1.6 CONVENTIONS AND DEFINITIONS

1.6.1 DEFINITIONS

1.6.1.1 Definitions from the Open Systems Interconnection Basic Reference Model

This Recommended Standard makes use of a number of terms defined in reference [1] – Open Systems Interconnection (OSI) Basic Reference Model. The use of those terms in this Recommended Standard is to be understood in a generic sense, i.e., in the sense that those terms are generally applicable to any of a variety of technologies that provide for the exchange of information between real systems. Those terms are:

- a) blocking;
- b) connection;
- c) Data Link Layer;
- d) entity;
- e) flow control;
- f) Network Layer;
- g) peer entities;
- h) Physical Layer;
- i) protocol control information;
- j) protocol data unit;
- k) real system;
- l) segmenting;
- m) service;
- n) Service Access Point (SAP);
- o) SAP address;
- p) service data unit.

1.6.1.2 Definitions from OSI Service Definition Conventions

This Recommended Standard makes use of a number of terms defined in reference [2]. The use of those terms in this Recommended Standard is to be understood in a generic sense, i.e., in the sense that those terms are generally applicable to any of a variety of technologies that provide for the exchange of information between real systems. Those terms are:

- a) confirmation;
- b) indication;
- c) primitive;
- d) request;
- e) response;
- f) service provider;
- g) service user.

1.6.1.3 Terms Defined in This Recommended Standard

For the purposes of this Recommended Standard, the following definitions also apply. Many other terms that pertain to specific items are defined in the appropriate sections.

aperiodic: not *periodic* (see below).

asynchronous: not *synchronous* (see below).

delimited: having a known (and finite) length; applies to data in the context of data handling.

Mission Phase: a period of a mission during which specified communications characteristics are fixed. The transition between two consecutive Mission Phases may cause an interruption of the communications services.

periodic: of or pertaining to a sequence of events in which each event occurs at a fixed time interval (within specified tolerance) after the previous event in the sequence.

Physical Channel: a stream of bits transferred over a space link in a single direction.

space link: a communications link between a spacecraft and its associated ground system or between two spacecraft. A space link consists of one or more Physical Channels in one or both directions.

synchronous: of or pertaining to a sequence of events occurring in a fixed time relationship (within specified tolerance) to another sequence of events. It should be noted that ‘synchronous’ does not necessarily imply ‘periodic’ or ‘constant rate’.

(AOS) transfer frame: The protocol data unit of the Advanced Orbiting Systems (AOS) Space Data Link Protocol.

1.6.2 NOMENCLATURE

1.6.2.1 Normative Text

The following conventions apply for the normative specifications in this Recommended Standard:

- a) the words ‘shall’ and ‘must’ imply a binding and verifiable specification;
- b) the word ‘should’ implies an optional, but desirable, specification;
- c) the word ‘may’ implies an optional specification;
- d) the words ‘is’, ‘are’, and ‘will’ imply statements of fact.

NOTE – These conventions do not imply constraints on diction in text that is clearly informative in nature.

1.6.2.2 Informative Text

In the normative sections of this document, informative text is set off from the normative specifications either in notes or under one of the following subsection headings:

- Overview;
- Background;
- Rationale;
- Discussion.

1.6.3 CONVENTIONS

In this document, the following convention is used to identify each bit in an N -bit field. The first bit in the field to be transmitted (i.e., the most left-justified when drawing a figure) is defined to be ‘Bit 0’; the following bit is defined to be ‘Bit 1’ and so on up to ‘Bit $N-1$ ’. When the field is used to express a binary value (such as a counter), the Most Significant Bit (MSB) shall be the first transmitted bit of the field, i.e., ‘Bit 0’ (see figure 1-1).

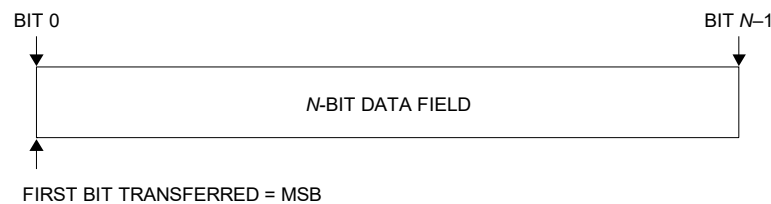


Figure 1-1: Bit Numbering Convention

In accordance with standard data-communications practice, data fields are often grouped into eight-bit ‘words’ which conform to the above convention. Throughout this Recommended Standard, such an eight-bit word is called an ‘octet’. The numbering for octets within a data structure starts with zero. By CCSDS convention, all ‘spare’ bits shall be permanently set to ‘0’.

1.7 REFERENCES

The following publications contain provisions which, through reference in this text, constitute provisions of this document. At the time of publication, the editions indicated were valid. All publications are subject to revision, and users of this document are encouraged to investigate the

possibility of applying the most recent editions of the publications indicated below. The CCSDS Secretariat maintains a register of currently valid CCSDS publications.

- [1] *Information Technology—Open Systems Interconnection—Basic Reference Model: The Basic Model*. 2nd ed. International Standard, ISO/IEC 7498-1:1994. Geneva: ISO, 1994.
- [2] *Information Technology—Open Systems Interconnection—Basic Reference Model—Conventions for the Definition of OSI Services*. International Standard, ISO/IEC 10731:1994. Geneva: ISO, 1994.
- [3] *TM Synchronization and Channel Coding*. Issue 4. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 131.0-B-5. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, September 2023.
- [4] *Flexible Advanced Coding and Modulation Scheme for High Rate Telemetry Applications*. Issue 2. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 131.2-B-2. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, February 2023.
- [5] *CCSDS Space Link Protocols over ETSI DVB-S2 Standard*. Issue 2. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 131.3-B-2. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, April 2022.
- [6] “Packet Version Number.” Space Assigned Numbers Authority. https://sanaregistry.org/r/packet_version_number.
- [7] *CCSDS Spacecraft Identification Field Code Assignment Control Procedures*. Issue 7. Recommendation for Space Data System Practices (Magenta Book), CCSDS 320.0-M-7. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, November 2017.
- [8] *Space Packet Protocol*. Issue 2. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 133.0-B-2. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, June 2020.
- [9] *Encapsulation Packet Protocol*. Issue 3. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 133.1-B-3. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, May 2020.
- [10] *Space Data Link Security Protocol*. Issue 2. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 355.0-B-2. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, July 2022.
- [11] *Space Data Link Security Protocol—Extended Procedures*. Issue 1. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 355.1-B-1. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, February 2020.

NOTE — Informative references are listed in annex C.

2 OVERVIEW

2.1 CONCEPT OF AOS SPACE DATA LINK PROTOCOL

2.1.1 ARCHITECTURE

The AOS Space Data Link Protocol is a Data Link Layer protocol (see reference [1]) to be used by space missions. This protocol has been designed to meet the requirements of space missions for efficient transfer of space application data of various types and characteristics over space-to-ground, ground-to-space, or space-to-space communications links (hereafter called space links).

Figure 2-1 illustrates the relationship of this protocol to the reference model of Open Systems Interconnection (reference [1]). Two sublayers of the Data Link Layer are defined for CCSDS space link protocols as shown in reference [C2]. The AOS Space Data Link Protocol corresponds to the Data Link Protocol Sublayer and provides functions of transferring various data using a fixed-length protocol data unit called the Transfer Frame. The optional Space Data Link Layer Security Protocol (reference [10]) is provided within the Data Link Protocol Sublayer, as illustrated below. The Synchronization and Channel Coding Sublayer provides some additional functions necessary for transferring Transfer Frames over a space link. These functions are delimiting/synchronizing Transfer Frames, error-correction coding/decoding (optional), and bit transition generation/removal (optional). For the Synchronization and Channel Coding Sublayer, the set of TM Synchronization and Channel Coding Recommended Standards (references [3], [4], and [5]) must be used with the AOS Space Data Link Protocol. How the AOS Space Data Link Protocol is used in overall space data systems is shown in references [C2], [C3], and [C4].

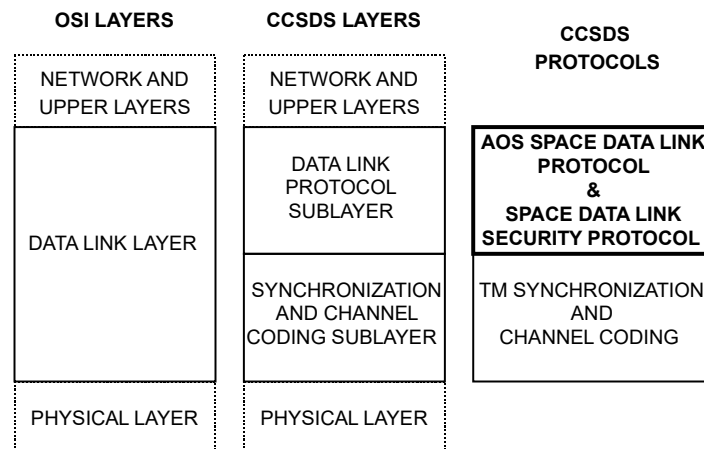


Figure 2-1: Relationship with OSI Layers

2.1.2 PROTOCOL FEATURES

2.1.2.1 Transfer Frames and Virtual Channels

The AOS Space Data Link Protocol provides the users with several services to transfer service data units over a space link. To facilitate simple, reliable, and robust synchronization procedures, fixed-length protocol data units are used to transfer data through the weak-signal, noisy space links: their length is established for a particular Physical Channel (a single stream of bits transferred over a space link in a single direction) during a particular Mission Phase by management. These protocol data units are known as AOS Transfer Frames (unless otherwise stated, the terms ‘Transfer Frame’ and ‘Frame’ in this document refer to the AOS Transfer Frame). Each Transfer Frame contains a header which provides protocol control information and a fixed-length data field within which higher-layer service data units are carried.

A key feature of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol is the concept of ‘Virtual Channels’ (VCs). The VC facility allows one Physical Channel to be shared among multiple higher-layer data streams, each of which may have different service requirements. A single Physical Channel may therefore be divided into several separate logical data channels, each known as a ‘Virtual Channel’. Each Transfer Frame transferred over a Physical Channel belongs to one of the VCs of the Physical Channel.

2.1.2.2 Optional Space Data Link Security Protocol

The Data Link Protocol Sublayer includes the Space Data Link Security (SDLS) Protocol specified in reference [10]. The SDLS protocol can provide security, such as authentication and confidentiality, for AOS Transfer Frames. Support for the SDLS protocol is an optional feature of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol.

NOTE – The introduction of the SDLS protocol makes no changes to any requirements in this Recommended Standard that apply to an AOS Space Data Link Protocol that does not support the SDLS protocol.

The security provided by the SDLS protocol can vary between VCs. So, for example, there can be some VCs with security and some without. The type of security can vary from one VC to another.

2.1.3 ADDRESSING

There are three identifier fields in the header of Transfer Frames: Transfer Frame Version Number (TFVN), Spacecraft Identifier (SCID), and Virtual Channel Identifier (VCID). The concatenation of a TFVN and a SCID is known as a Master Channel Identifier (MCID), and the concatenation of an MCID and a VCID is called a Global Virtual Channel Identifier (GVCID). Therefore,

$$\text{MCID} = \text{TFVN} + \text{SCID};$$

$$\text{GVCID} = \text{MCID} + \text{VCID} = \text{TFVN} + \text{SCID} + \text{VCID}.$$

Each VC in a Physical Channel is identified by a GVCID. Therefore, a VC consists of Transfer Frames with the same GVCID.

All Transfer Frames with the same MCID on a Physical Channel constitute a Master Channel (MC), which consists of one or more VCs. In most cases, a Physical Channel carries only Transfer Frames of a single MCID, and the MC will be identical with the Physical Channel. However, a Physical Channel may carry Transfer Frames with multiple MCIDs (with the same TFVN). In such a case, the Physical Channel consists of multiple MCs. A Physical Channel is identified with a Physical Channel Name, which is set by management and not included in the header of Transfer Frames.

The relationships between these Channels are shown in figure 2-2.

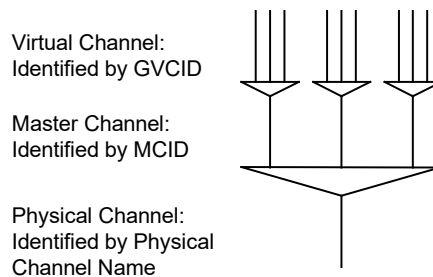


Figure 2-2: Relationships between Channels

2.1.4 PROTOCOL DESCRIPTION

The AOS Space Data Link Protocol is described in terms of:

- a) the services provided to the users;
- b) the protocol data units; and
- c) the procedures performed by the protocol.

The service definitions are given in the form of primitives, which present an abstract model of the logical exchange of data and control information between the protocol entity and the service user. The definitions of primitives are independent of specific implementation approaches.

The procedure specifications define the procedures performed by protocol entities for the transfer of information between peer entities. The definitions of procedures are independent of specific implementation methods or technologies.

This protocol specification also specifies the requirements for the underlying services provided by the Channel Coding Sublayer and the Physical Layer.

2.2 OVERVIEW OF SERVICES

2.2.1 COMMON FEATURES OF SERVICES

The AOS Space Data Link Protocol provides users with data transfer services. The point at which a service is provided by a protocol entity to a user is called a Service Access Point (SAP) (see reference [1]). Each service user is identified by a SAP address.

Service data units submitted to a SAP are processed in the order of submission. No processing order is maintained for service data units submitted to different SAPs.

NOTE – Implementations may be required to perform flow control at an SAP between the service user and the service provider. However, CCSDS does not recommend a scheme for flow control between the user and the provider.

The following features are common to all the services defined by this Recommended Standard:

- a) unidirectional (one way) services: one end of a connection can send, but not receive, data through the space link, while the other end can receive, but not send;
- b) unconfirmed services: the sending user does not receive confirmation from the receiving end that data has been received;
- c) incomplete services: the services do not guarantee completeness, but some services may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user;
- d) sequence-preserving services: the sequence of service data units supplied by the sending user is preserved through the transfer over the space link, although there may be gaps and duplications in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

NOTE – This Recommended Standard assumes that these services are provided at the end points of a space link. However, this Recommended Standard makes no assumptions concerning how these end points are composed or configured either on-board a spacecraft or in a ground system. In a ground system, the services defined by this Recommended Standard may be extended or enhanced with Space Link Extension Services (reference [C5]).

2.2.2 SERVICE TYPES

2.2.2.1 Overview

The AOS Space Data Link Protocol provides three service types (asynchronous, synchronous, and periodic) that determine how service data units supplied by the user are transferred in protocol data units over a space link.

The models shown below are intended only to illustrate the characteristics of services. They are not intended to guide or restrict design of on-board or ground systems.

2.2.2.2 Asynchronous Service

In asynchronous service, there are no timing relationships between the transfer of service data units supplied by the service user and the transmission of Transfer Frames generated by the service provider. The user may request data transfer at any time it desires, but there may be restrictions imposed by the provider on the data generation rate. In this service (figure 2-3), each service data unit from a sending user is placed in a queue, the contents of which are sent to a receiving user in the order in which they were presented. Although transmission errors may prevent delivery of some data units, the service provider attempts to transfer all data units provided by the user exactly once. The timing of data transfer is determined by the provider in accordance with mission-specific rules and may depend on the traffic at the time of transfer. The key feature of this service is that all of the service data units from the sending user are transferred exactly once.

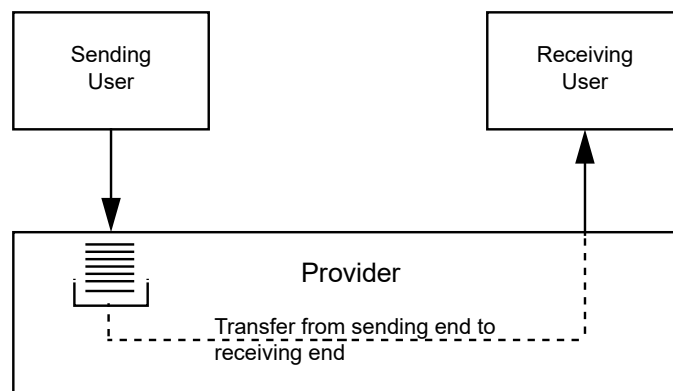


Figure 2-3: Asynchronous Service Model

2.2.2.3 Synchronous Service

In synchronous service, the transfer of service data units is synchronized with the release of either (1) Transfer Frames of a VC, (2) Transfer Frames of an MC, or (3) all Transfer Frames of a Physical Channel. The transfer timing may be periodic or aperiodic.

In this service (figure 2-4), each service data unit from a sending user is placed in a buffer that can hold only one service data unit; the content of the buffer is sent to a receiving user at the time when a Transfer Frame is transmitted. The transmission timing of Transfer Frames is determined by the service provider according to mission-specific rules (usually known to the user). The key feature of this service, which is essentially time-division multiplexing, is that the timing of data transfer is driven by the transfer mechanism, not by individual service requests from the user. Thus, a particular service data unit from a user might be sent once, several times (if the 'new' value is not placed in the buffer soon enough), or not at all (if one value is replaced by a second before the service provider can send it).

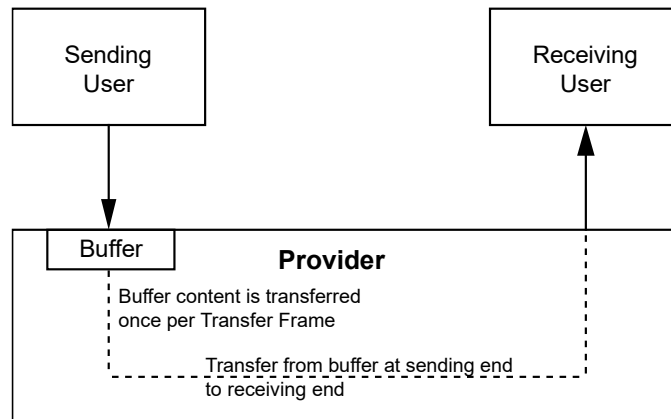


Figure 2-4: Synchronous Service Model

2.2.2.4 Periodic Service

Periodic service is a special case of synchronous service in which service data units are transferred at a constant rate. Periodic transfer from service interface to service interface is provided with a specified maximum delay and a specified maximum jitter at the service interface. There are three cases in which a synchronous service is periodic:

- a) If the service is associated with a VC or MC which produce Transfer Frames at a constant rate, then the service is periodic.
- b) If the service is associated with an MC and there is only one MC in the Physical Channel, then the service is periodic.

For periodic services, all service data units are sent only once if the user supplies service data units at the same rate as the rate at which the service provider transfers them.

2.2.3 SUMMARY OF SERVICES

2.2.3.1 Overview

Seven services are provided by the AOS Space Data Link Protocol:

- a) Five of them are provided for a VC:
 1. VC Packet (VCP);
 2. Bitstream;
 3. VC Access (VCA);
 4. VC Operational Control Field (VC_OCF);
 5. VC Frame (VCF).
- b) One of them – MC Frame (MCF) – is provided for an MC.
- c) One of them – Insert – is provided for all Transfer Frames in a Physical Channel.

Table 2-1 summarizes these services and shows their characteristics, the Service Data Units (SDUs) that they transfer and the availability of SDLS security features. The optional SDLS protocol can provide security features for the SDUs transferred by some of the services:

- encryption, to provide confidentiality by hiding data content;
- authentication, to confirm the source and integrity of the data.

Table 2-1: Summary of Services Provided by AOS Space Data Link Protocol

Service	Service Type	Service Data Unit	SAP Address	SDLS Security Features
Virtual Channel Packet (VCP) [†]	Asynchronous	Packet	GVCID + Packet Version Number	All
Bitstream	Asynchronous or Periodic	Bitstream Data	GVCID	All
Virtual Channel Access (VCA)	Asynchronous or Periodic	VCA_SDU	GVCID	All
Virtual Channel Operational Control Field (VC_OCF)	Synchronous or Periodic	OCF_SDU	GVCID	None
Virtual Channel Frame (VCF)	Asynchronous or Periodic	Transfer Frame	GVCID	None
Master Channel Frame (MCF)	Asynchronous or Periodic	Transfer Frame	MCID	None
Insert	Periodic	IN_SDU	Physical Channel Name	None
[†] The term ‘Packet Service’ is used as an abbreviation for Virtual Channel Packet (VCP) Service.				

2.2.3.2 Virtual Channel Packet Service

The VCP Service transfers a sequence of variable-length, delimited, octet-aligned service data units known as Packets across a space link. The Packets transferred by this service must have a Packet Version Number (PVN) authorized by CCSDS. Packet Version Numbers presently authorized by CCSDS are defined in reference [6]. The service is unidirectional, asynchronous and sequence-preserving. It does not guarantee completeness, nor does it signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to a receiving user.

A user of this service is a protocol entity that sends or receives CCSDS-recognized Packets (identified by its PVN) carried across the Global Virtual Channel (identified by its GVCID). Different users (i.e., Packets with different versions) can share a single VC, and if there are multiple users on a VC, the service provider multiplexes Packets of different versions to form a single stream of Packets to be transferred on that VC.

2.2.3.3 Bitstream Service

The Bitstream service provides transfer of a serial string of bits, whose internal structure and boundaries are unknown to the service provider, across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

For a given service instance, only one user, identified with the GVCID of the VC, can use this service on a VC. Bitstreams from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

2.2.3.4 Virtual Channel Access Service

The VCA Service provides transfer of a sequence of privately formatted service data units of fixed length across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

For a given service instance, only one user, identified with the GVCID of the VC, can use this service on a VC. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

2.2.3.5 Virtual Channel Operational Control Field Service

The VC_OCF Service provides synchronous transfer of fixed-length data units, each consisting of four octets, in the Operational Control Field (OCF) of Transfer Frames of a VC. The service is unidirectional and sequence-preserving. The transfer is synchronized with the release of Transfer Frames of a VC. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

For a given service instance, only one user, identified with the GVCID of the VC, can use this service on a VC. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

2.2.3.6 Virtual Channel Frame Service

The VCF Service provides transfer of a sequence of fixed-length AOS Transfer Frames of a VC, created by an independent protocol entity, across a space link. The service is

unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

For a given service instance, only one user, identified with the GVCID of the VC, can use this service on a VC, and each VCF Service instance on a Physical Channel must utilize a unique GVCID value. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

The VCF Service transfers the independently created AOS Transfer Frames through a space link, possibly together with AOS Transfer Frames identified by other GVCID values created by the service provider itself. Necessarily, the independent Transfer Frames must have the same length as those generated by the service provider. Moreover, transfer frames provided by the VCF Service User are partially formatted AOS Transfer Frames as defined in 3.2.6.

2.2.3.7 Master Channel Frame Service

The MCF Service provides transfer of a sequence of fixed-length AOS Transfer Frames of an MC, created by an independent protocol entity, across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to a receiving user.

For a given service instance, only one user, identified with the MCID of the MC, can use this service on an MC, and each MCF Service instance on a Physical Channel must utilize a unique MCID value. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one MC.

The MCF Service transfers the independently created AOS Transfer Frames through the space link, possibly together with AOS Transfer Frames identified by other MCID values created by the service provider itself. Necessarily, the independent Transfer Frames must have the same length as those generated by the service provider. Moreover, transfer frames provided by the MCF Service User are partially formatted AOS Transfer Frames as defined in 3.2.6.

2.2.3.8 Insert Service

The Insert Service provides transfer of private, fixed-length, octet-aligned service data units across a space link in a mode which efficiently utilizes the space link transmission resources at relatively low data rates. The service is unidirectional, periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to a receiving user.

For a given service instance, only one user, identified with the Physical Channel Name of the Physical Channel, can use this service on a Physical Channel. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one Physical Channel.

2.2.4 RESTRICTIONS ON SERVICES

There are some restrictions on the services provided on a Physical Channel, as follows:

- a) On one Physical Channel, the Insert Service shall not exist simultaneously with the VCF or MCF Service.
- b) If the MCF Service exists on an MC, other services shall not exist simultaneously on that MC.
- c) If the VCF Service exists on a VC, other services shall not exist simultaneously on that VC.
- d) On a VC on which the VCF Service does not exist, only one of the VCP, Bitstream, or VCA Services shall exist simultaneously.

2.3 OVERVIEW OF FUNCTIONS

2.3.1 GENERAL FUNCTIONS

The AOS Space Data Link Protocol transfers various service data units supplied by sending users encapsulated in a sequence of protocol data units using services of lower layers. The protocol data units, known as AOS Transfer Frames, have a fixed length and must be transferred over a Physical Channel at a constant rate.

The protocol entity performs the following protocol functions:

- a) generation and processing of protocol control information (i.e., headers and trailers) to perform data identification, loss detection, and error detection;
- b) segmenting and blocking of service data units to transfer variable-length service data units in fixed-length protocol data units;
- c) multiplexing/demultiplexing and commutation/decommutation in order for various service users to share a single Physical Channel;
- d) generation and removal of idle data to transfer protocol data units at a constant rate.

If the protocol entity supports the optional SDLS protocol, then it uses the functions of SDLS to apply the configured security features.

The protocol entity does not perform the following protocol functions:

- d) connection establishment and release;
- e) flow control;
- f) retransmission of protocol data units;
- g) management or configuration of the SDLS protocol.

2.3.2 INTERNAL ORGANIZATION OF PROTOCOL ENTITY

Figures 2-5 and 2-6 show the internal organization of the protocol entity of the sending and receiving ends, respectively. Data flow from top to bottom in figure 2-5 and from bottom to top in figure 2-6. These figures identify data-handling functions performed by the protocol entity and show logical relationships among these functions. The figures are not intended to imply any hardware or software configuration in a real system. Depending on the services actually used for a real system, not all of the functions may be present in the protocol entity.

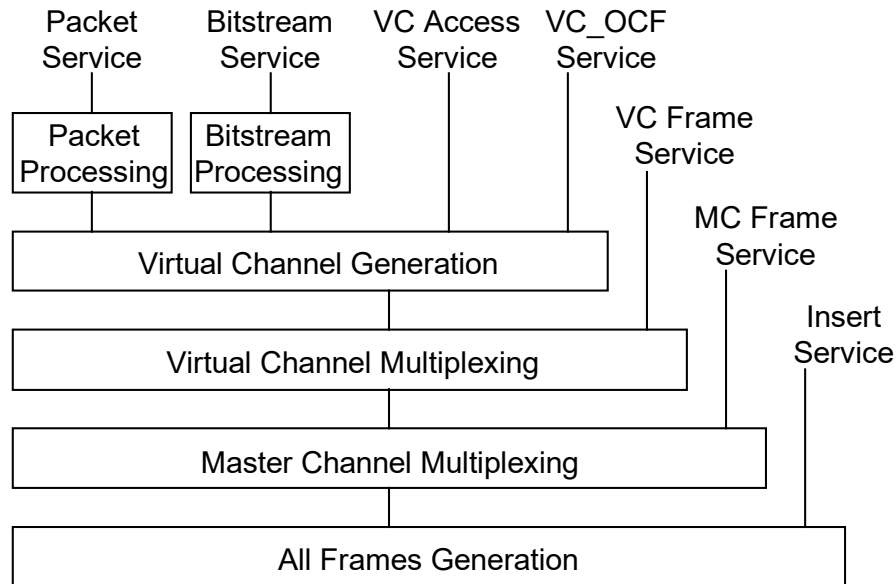


Figure 2-5: Internal Organization of Protocol Entity (Sending End)

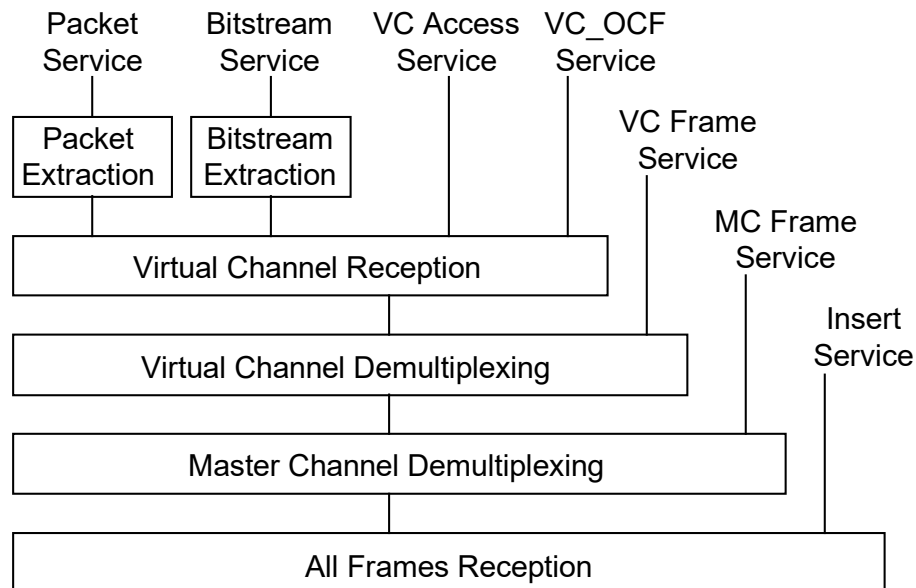


Figure 2-6: Internal Organization of Protocol Entity (Receiving End)

By extracting multiplexing/demultiplexing and commutation/decommutation functions from figures 2-5 and 2-6, the relationship among various data units can be shown as figure 2-7, which is known as the Channel Tree of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol.

In figure 2-7, multiplexing (shown with a triangle) is a function of mixing, according to an algorithm established by the project, multiple streams of data units, each with a different identifier, to generate a single stream of data units. Commutation (shown with a box) is a function of concatenating, according to the formatting rule specified by the protocol definition, multiple data units, each from a different service, in a single protocol data unit sharing the same identifier.

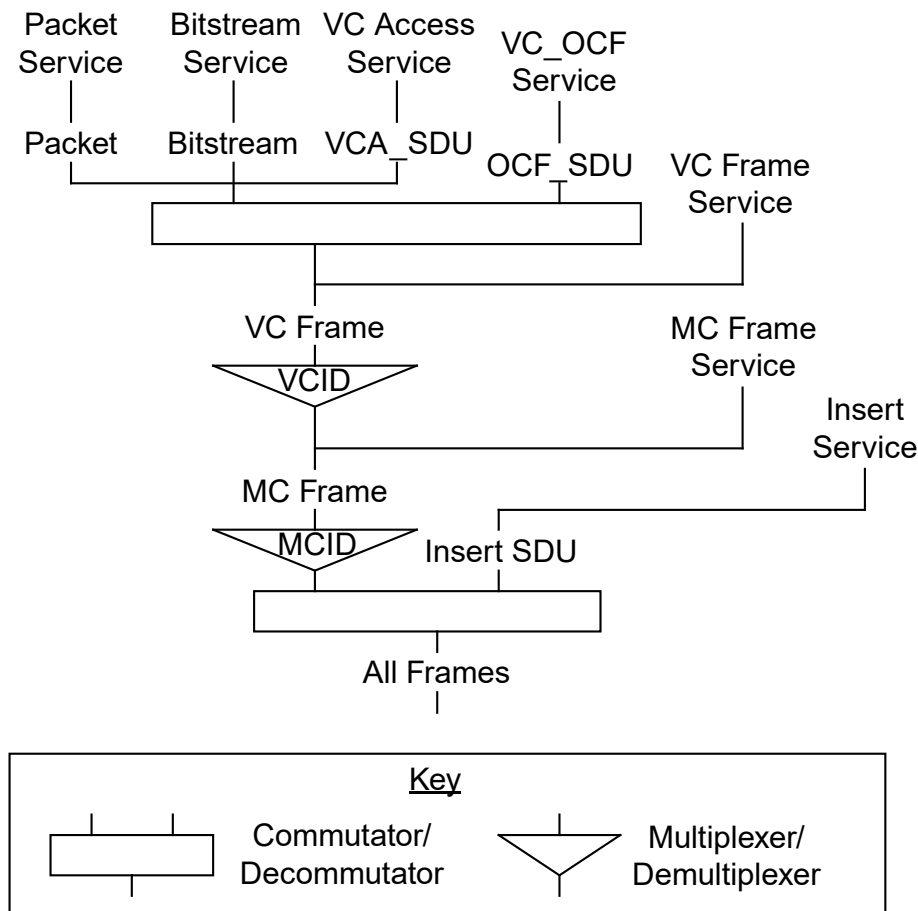


Figure 2-7: AOS Space Data Link Protocol Channel Tree

2.4 SERVICES ASSUMED FROM LOWER LAYERS

2.4.1 SERVICES ASSUMED FROM SYNCHRONIZATION AND CHANNEL CODING SUBLAYER

As described in 2.1.1, the set of TM Channel Coding and Synchronization Recommended Standards (references [3], [4], and [5]) must be used with the AOS Space Data Link Protocol as the TM Synchronization and Channel Coding Sublayer specification. The functions provided by the Synchronization and Channel Coding Recommended Standard are:

- a) error control encoding and decoding functions (optional);
- b) bit transition generation and removal functions (optional);
- c) delimiting and synchronizing functions.

The TM Synchronization and Channel Coding Sublayer, then, transfers contiguous, fixed-length, delimited protocol data units as a contiguous stream of bits over a space link using the services of the underlying Physical Layer.

2.4.2 PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS TO LOWER LAYERS

The coding options of the Channel Coding and Synchronization Recommended Standard and the performance of the RF link provided by the Physical Layer shall be chosen according to the following criteria:

- a) The probability of misidentifying the MCID and VCID shall be less than a mission-specified value.
- b) The probability of not correctly extracting Packets from Transfer Frames using the First Header Pointer and the Packet Length Field shall be less than a mission-specified value.

In order to assure correct decoding at the receiving end, the same coding options must be applied to all Transfer Frames of a Physical Channel.

3 SERVICE DEFINITION

3.1 OVERVIEW

This section provides service definition in the form of primitives, which present an abstract model of the logical exchange of data and control information between the protocol entity and the service user. The definitions of primitives are independent of specific implementation approaches.

The parameters of the primitives are specified in an abstract sense and specify the information to be made available to the user of the primitives. The way in which a specific implementation makes this information available is not constrained by this specification. In addition to the parameters specified in this section, an implementation may provide other parameters to the service user (e.g., parameters for controlling the service, monitoring performance, facilitating diagnosis, and so on).

3.2 SOURCE DATA

3.2.1 SOURCE DATA OVERVIEW

This subsection describes the service data units that are transferred from sending users to receiving users by the AOS Space Data Link Protocol.

The service data units transferred by the AOS Space Data Link Protocol shall be:

- a) Packet;
- b) Bitstream Data;
- c) Virtual Channel Access Service Data Unit (VCA_SDU);
- d) Operational Control Field Service Data Unit (OCF_SDU);
- e) AOS Transfer Frame;
- f) Insert Service Data Unit (IN_SDU).

3.2.2 PACKET

3.2.2.1 Packets shall be transferred over a space link with the VCP Service.

3.2.2.2 The Packets transferred by this service must have a PVN authorized by CCSDS.

3.2.2.3 The position and length of the Packet Length Field of the Packets must be known to the service provider in order to extract Packets from Transfer Frames at the receiving end.

NOTES

- 1 Packets are variable-length, delimited, octet-aligned data units and are usually the protocol data unit of a Network Layer protocol.
- 2 Reference [6] defines both the Packet Version Numbers presently authorized by CCSDS and the corresponding packet format to which transferred Packets must conform.

3.2.3 BITSTREAM DATA

Bitstream Data shall be transferred over a space link with the Bitstream Service. The length of the Bitstream Data supplied in each Bitstream service request may not be preserved through transfer, since the Bitstream Data supplied in a service request may be segmented into multiple Transfer Frames or blocked in a Transfer Frame with the data supplied in other service requests.

NOTE – Bitstream Data are variable-length, undelimited strings of bits, the format of which is unknown to the service provider.

3.2.4 VIRTUAL CHANNEL ACCESS SERVICE DATA UNIT

Virtual Channel Access Service Data Units (VCA_SDUs) shall be transferred over a space link with the VCA Service.

NOTE – VCA_SDUs are fixed-length, octet-aligned data units, the format of which is unknown to the service provider. Their length is established by management.

3.2.5 OPERATIONAL CONTROL FIELD SERVICE DATA UNIT

3.2.5.1 OCF Service Data Units (OCF_SDUs) shall be transferred over a space link with the VC_OCF Service. Data units shall be carried in every Transfer Frame of a VC.

3.2.5.2 Although the transfer of OCF_SDUs is synchronized with the VC that shall provide the transfer service, the creation of OCF_SDUs by the sending user may or may not be synchronized with the VC. Such synchronization, if required for timing or other purposes, is a mission-design issue.

NOTES

- 1 OCF_SDUs are fixed-length data units, each consisting of four octets, carried in the OCF, defined in 4.1.5, from a sending end to a receiving end.
- 2 As defined in 4.1.5, CCSDS specifies the use of the first bit of this field to indicate the type of data carried.

3.2.6 AOS TRANSFER FRAME

The following restriction applies to AOS Transfer Frames: if at least a VCF service (see 3.7) or an MCF Service (see 3.8) exists, all AOS Transfer Frames on the Physical Channel shall not include the Transfer Frame Insert Zone.

NOTES

- 1 The AOS Transfer Frame is the fixed-length protocol data unit of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol, but also can be used as the service data units of the VCF and MCF Services. Its format is defined in 4.1 and 6.3 of this Recommended Standard. The length of any Transfer Frame transferred on a Physical Channel must be the same and is established by management.
- 2 Unlike TM Transfer Frames, AOS Transfer Frames transferred by the VCF and MCF Services are complete AOS transfer frames preventing periodic transmission of the Insert Zone SDUs at a constant frame rate.

3.2.7 INSERT SERVICE DATA UNIT

Insert Service Data Units (IN_SDUs) are periodic, octet-aligned data units of fixed length. Their length may be of any constant value which is an integral number of octets, between 1 octet and the maximum length of the data-carrying space of the Transfer Frames, and is established by management. The length of IN_SDUs at the sending interface is always equal to the length at the receiving interface.

3.3 VIRTUAL CHANNEL PACKET SERVICE

3.3.1 OVERVIEW OF VIRTUAL CHANNEL PACKET SERVICE

The VCP Service transfers a sequence of variable-length, delimited, octet-aligned service data units known as Packets across a space link. The Packets transferred by this service must have a PVN authorized by CCSDS. Packet Version Numbers presently authorized by CCSDS are defined in reference [6]. The service is unidirectional, asynchronous, and sequence-preserving. It does not guarantee completeness, nor does it signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to a receiving user.

A user of this service is a protocol entity that sends or receives CCSDS recognized Packets (identified by its PVN) carried across the Global Virtual Channel (identified by its GVCID). Different users (i.e., Packets with different versions) can share a single VC, and if there are multiple users on a VC, the service provider multiplexes Packets of different versions to form a single stream of Packets to be transferred on that VC.

3.3.2 VIRTUAL CHANNEL PACKET SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.3.2.1 General

The parameters used by the VCP Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.3.2.2 through 3.3.2.6.

3.3.2.2 Packet

The Packet parameter shall contain a Packet for transfer by the VCP Service.

NOTE – The Packet parameter is the service data unit transferred by the VCP Service. Restrictions on the Packets transferred by the VCP Service are stated in 3.2.2.

3.3.2.3 Global Virtual Channel Identifier

The GVCID parameter shall contain a GVCID that indicates the VC through which the Packet is to be transferred.

NOTE – The GVCID is part of the SAP address of the VCP Service.

3.3.2.4 Packet Version Number

The PVN shall identify the protocol entity of the upper layer that uses the VCP Service.

NOTE – The PVN is part of the SAP address of the VCP Service.

3.3.2.5 Packet Quality Indicator

The Packet Quality Indicator is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the VCP Service whether the Packet delivered by the primitive is complete or partial.

3.3.2.6 Verification Status Code

3.3.2.6.1 The Verification Status Code is an optional parameter that may be used if the service provider supports the optional SDLS protocol.

3.3.2.6.2 The Verification Status Code parameter shall be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the VCP Service of a verification failure in a transfer frame addressed to the VC.

3.3.2.6.3 A non-zero value shall indicate that the SDLS protocol has detected an error; the values taken by this parameter are defined in reference [10].

NOTE — A non-zero value of the Verification Status Code does not indicate an error in the delivered Packet. Processing of frames failing verification is implementation-specific and depends also on the processing capabilities of the service user for eventual forensic investigation.

3.3.3 VCP SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.3.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) VCP.request;
- b) VCP.indication.

3.3.3.2 VCP.request

3.3.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the VCP Service user shall pass a VCP.request primitive to the service provider to request that a Packet be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified VC.

NOTE — The VCP.request primitive is the service request primitive for the VCP Service.

3.3.3.2.2 Semantics

The VCP.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VCP.request	(Packet, GVCID, Packet Version Number)
-------------	--

3.3.3.2.3 When Generated

The VCP.request primitive shall be passed to the service provider to request it to send the Packet.

3.3.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the VCP.request primitive shall cause the service provider to transfer the Packet.

3.3.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The VCP.request primitive shall be used to transfer Packets across the space link on the specified VC.

3.3.3.3 VCP.indication

3.3.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass a VCP.indication to the VCP Service user to deliver a Packet.

NOTE – The VCP.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the VCP Service.

3.3.3.3.2 Semantics

The VCP.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VCP.indication	(Packet, GVCID, Packet Version Number, Packet Quality Indicator (optional), Verification Status Code (optional))
----------------	--

3.3.3.3.3 When Generated

The VCP.indication primitive shall be passed from the service provider to the VCP Service user at the receiving end to deliver a Packet.

3.3.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the VCP.indication primitive by the VCP Service user is undefined.

3.3.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The VCP.indication primitive shall be used to deliver Packets to the VCP Service user identified by the GVCID and Packet Version Number. Incomplete Packets may be delivered (optional).

3.4 BITSTREAM SERVICE

3.4.1 OVERVIEW OF BITSTREAM SERVICE

The Bitstream Service provides transfer of a serial string of bits, whose internal structure and boundaries are unknown to the service provider, across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

Only one user can use this service on a VC, and the user is identified with the GVCID of the VC. Bitstreams from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

3.4.2 BITSTREAM SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.4.2.1 General

The parameters used by the Bitstream Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.4.2.2 through 3.4.2.5.

3.4.2.2 Bitstream Data

The parameter Bitstream Data shall be the service data unit transferred by the Bitstream Service.

NOTE – Restrictions on the Bitstream Data transferred by the Bitstream Service are stated in 3.2.3 and 4.1.4.3.3.4.

3.4.2.3 GVCID

The GVCID parameter shall contain a GVCID that indicates the VC through which the Bitstream Data is to be transferred.

NOTE – The GVCID is the SAP address of the Bitstream Service.

3.4.2.4 Bitstream Data Loss Flag

The Bitstream Data Loss Flag is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the Bitstream Service that a sequence discontinuity has been detected, and that some Bitstream Data may have been lost. If implemented, the flag shall be derived by examining the VC Frame Count in the Transfer Frames.

NOTE – As the contents (valid Bitstream Data or idle data) of lost Transfer Frames cannot be established, the user should be aware that the Bitstream Data Loss Flag signals a disruption in the Transfer Frames of the specified VC, and not necessarily a disruption of the Bitstream Data itself.

3.4.2.5 Verification Status Code

3.4.2.5.1 The Verification Status Code is an optional parameter that may be used if the service provider supports the optional SDLS protocol.

3.4.2.5.2 The Verification Status Code parameter shall be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the Bitstream Service of a verification failure in a transfer frame addressed to the VC.

3.4.2.5.3 A non-zero value shall indicate that the SDLS protocol has detected an error: the values taken by this parameter are defined in reference [10].

NOTE – A non-zero value of the Verification Status Code does not indicate an error in the delivered Bitstream Data. Processing of frames failing verification is implementation-specific and depends also on the processing capabilities of the service user for eventual forensic investigation.

3.4.3 BITSTREAM SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.4.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) BITSTREAM.request;
- b) BITSTREAM.indication.

3.4.3.2 BITSTREAM.request

3.4.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the Bitstream Service user shall pass a BITSTREAM.request primitive to the service provider to request that Bitstream Data be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified VC.

NOTE – The BITSTREAM.request primitive is the service request primitive for the Bitstream Service.

3.4.3.2.2 Semantics

The BITSTREAM.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

BITSTREAM.request	(Bitstream Data, GVCID)
-------------------	----------------------------

3.4.3.2.3 When Generated

The BITSTREAM.request primitive shall be passed to the service provider to request it to send the Bitstream Data.

3.4.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the BITSTREAM.request primitive shall cause the service provider to transfer the Bitstream Data.

3.4.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The BITSTREAM.request primitive shall be used to transfer Bitstream Data across the space link on the specified VC.

NOTE – Since the service interface specification is an abstract specification, the implementation of the Bitstream Data parameter is not constrained; i.e., it may be continuous Bitstream, delimited Bitstream, or individual bits.

3.4.3.3 BITSTREAM.indication

3.4.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass a BITSTREAM.indication to the BITSTREAM Service user to deliver Bitstream Data.

NOTE – The BITSTREAM.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the Bitstream Service.

3.4.3.3.2 Semantics

The BITSTREAM.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

BITSTREAM.indication	(Bitstream Data, GVCID, Bitstream Data Loss Flag (optional), Verification Status Code (optional))
----------------------	--

3.4.3.3.3 When Generated

The BITSTREAM.indication primitive shall be passed from the service provider to the Bitstream Service user at the receiving end to deliver Bitstream Data.

3.4.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the BITSTREAM.indication primitive by the Bitstream Service user is undefined.

3.4.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The BITSTREAM.indication primitive shall be used to deliver Bitstream Data to the Bitstream Service user identified by the GVCID.

NOTE – The quantity of Bitstream Data delivered by an implementation of this service primitive is not defined. Therefore, it is not necessarily related to the quantity of Bitstream Data submitted to the service provider by the sending user with the BITSTREAM.request primitive.

3.5 VIRTUAL CHANNEL ACCESS SERVICE

3.5.1 OVERVIEW OF VIRTUAL CHANNEL ACCESS SERVICE

The VCA Service provides transfer of a sequence of privately formatted service data units of fixed length across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

Only one user can use this service on a VC, and the user is identified with the GVCID of the VC. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

3.5.2 VIRTUAL CHANNEL ACCESS SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.5.2.1 General

The parameters used by the VCA Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.5.2.2 through 3.5.2.5.

3.5.2.2 VCA_SDU

The parameter VCA_SDU shall be the service data unit transferred by the VCA Service.

NOTE – Restrictions on the VCA_SDUs transferred by the VCA Service are stated in 3.2.4.

3.5.2.3 Global Virtual Channel Identifier

The GVCID parameter shall contain a GVCID that indicates the VC through which the VCA_SDU is to be transferred.

NOTE – The GVCID is the SAP address of the VCA Service.

3.5.2.4 VCA_SDU Loss Flag

The VCA_SDU Loss Flag is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the VCA Service that a sequence discontinuity has been detected, and that one or more VCA_SDUs have been lost. If implemented, the flag shall be derived by examining the VC Frame Count in the Transfer Frames.

3.5.2.5 Verification Status Code

3.5.2.5.1 The Verification Status Code is an optional parameter that may be used if the service provider supports the optional SDLS protocol.

3.5.2.5.2 The parameter shall be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the VCA Service of a verification failure in a transfer frame addressed to the VC.

3.5.2.5.3 A non-zero value shall indicate that the SDLS protocol has detected an error: the values taken by this parameter are defined in reference [10].

NOTE – A non-zero value of the Verification Status Code does not indicate an error in the delivered VCA_SDU. Processing of frames failing verification is implementation-specific and depends also on the processing capabilities of the service user for eventual forensic investigation.

3.5.3 VCA SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.5.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) VCA.request;
- b) VCA.indication.

3.5.3.2 VCA.request

3.5.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the VCA Service user shall pass a VCA.request primitive to the service provider to request that a VCA_SDU be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified VC.

NOTE – The VCA.request primitive is the service request primitive for the VCA Service.

3.5.3.2.2 Semantics

The VCA.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VCA.request	(VCA_SDU, GVCID)
-------------	---------------------

3.5.3.2.3 When Generated

The VCA.request primitive shall be passed to the service provider to request it to send the VCA_SDU.

3.5.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the VCA.request primitive shall cause the service provider to transfer the VCA_SDU.

3.5.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The VCA.request primitive shall be used to transfer VCA_SDUs across the space link on the specified VC.

3.5.3.3 VCA.indication

3.5.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass a VCA.indication to the VCA Service user to deliver a VCA_SDU.

NOTE – The VCA.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the VCA Service.

3.5.3.3.2 Semantics

The VCA.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VCA.indication	(VCA_SDU, GVCID, VCA_SDU Loss Flag (optional), Verification Status Code (optional))
----------------	--

3.5.3.3.3 When Generated

The VCA.indication primitive shall be passed from the service provider to the VCA Service user at the receiving end to deliver a VCA_SDU.

3.5.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the VCA.indication primitive by the VCA Service user is undefined.

3.5.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The VCA.indication primitive shall be used to deliver VCA_SDUs to the VCA Service user identified by the GVCID.

3.6 VIRTUAL CHANNEL OPERATIONAL CONTROL FIELD SERVICE

3.6.1 OVERVIEW OF VC_OCF SERVICE

The Virtual Channel Operational Control Field (VC_OCF) Service provides synchronous transfer of fixed-length data units, each consisting of four octets, in the OCF of Transfer Frames of a VC. The service is unidirectional and sequence-preserving. The transfer is synchronized with the release of Transfer Frames of a VC. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

Only one user can use this service on a VC, and the user is identified with the GVCID of the VC. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

3.6.2 VC_OCF SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.6.2.1 General

The parameters used by the VC_OCF Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.6.2.2 through 3.6.2.4.

3.6.2.2 OCF_SDU

The parameter OCF_SDU shall be the service data unit transferred by the VC_OCF Service in the OCF of Transfer Frames of a VC.

NOTE — Restrictions on the OCF_SDU transferred by the VC_OCF Service are stated in 3.2.5.

3.6.2.3 Global Virtual Channel Identifier

The GVCID parameter shall contain a GVCID that indicates the VC through which the OCF_SDU is to be transferred.

NOTE — The GVCID is the SAP address of the VC_OCF Service.

3.6.2.4 OCF_SDU Loss Flag

The OCF_SDU Loss Flag is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the VC_OCF Service that a sequence discontinuity has been detected, and that one or more OCF_SDUs may have been lost. If implemented, the flag shall be derived by examining the VC Frame Count in the Transfer Frames.

3.6.3 VC_OCF SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.6.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) VC_OCF.request;
- b) VC_OCF.indication.

3.6.3.2 VC_OCF.request

3.6.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the VC_OCF Service user shall pass a VC_OCF.request primitive to the service provider to request that an OCF_SDU be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified VC.

NOTE — The VC_OCF.request primitive is the service request primitive for the VC_OCF Service.

3.6.3.2.2 Semantics

The VC_OCF.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VC_OCF.request	(OCF_SDU, GVCID)
----------------	---------------------

3.6.3.2.3 When Generated

The VC_OCF.request primitive shall be passed to the service provider to request it to send the OCF_SDU.

3.6.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the VC_OCF.request primitive shall cause the service provider to transfer the OCF_SDU.

3.6.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The VC_OCF.request primitive shall be used to transfer OCF_SDUs across the space link on the specified VC.

3.6.3.3 VC_OCF.indication

3.6.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass a VC_OCF.indication to the VC_OCF Service user to deliver an OCF_SDU.

NOTE – The VC_OCF.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the VC_OCF Service.

3.6.3.3.2 Semantics

The VC_OCF.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VC_OCF.indication	(OCF_SDU, GVCID, OCF_SDU Loss Flag (optional))
-------------------	--

3.6.3.3.3 When Generated

The VC_OCF.indication primitive shall be passed from the service provider to the VC_OCF Service user at the receiving end to deliver an OCF_SDU.

3.6.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the VC_OCF.indication primitive by the VC_OCF Service user is undefined.

3.6.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The VC_OCF.indication primitive shall be used to deliver OCF_SDUs to the VC_OCF Service user identified by the GVCID.

3.7 VIRTUAL CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE

3.7.1 OVERVIEW OF VIRTUAL CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE

The VCF Service provides transfer of a sequence of fixed-length AOS Transfer Frames of a VC, created by an independent protocol entity, across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to the receiving user.

Only one user can use this service on a VC, and the user is identified with the GVCID of the VC. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one VC.

3.7.2 VIRTUAL CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.7.2.1 General

The parameters used by the VCF Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.7.2.2 through 3.7.2.4.

3.7.2.2 Frame

The Frame parameter shall be an AOS Transfer Frame of the VC specified by the GVCID parameter.

NOTES

- 1 The parameter Frame is the service data unit transferred by the VCF Service.
- 2 The format of the GVCID parameter is defined in 4.1.
- 3 Restrictions on the AOS Transfer Frames transferred by the VCF Service are stated in 3.2.6.

3.7.2.3 Global Virtual Channel Identifier

The GVCID parameter shall contain a GVCID that indicates the VC through which the Frame is to be transferred.

NOTE — The GVCID is the SAP address of the VCF Service.

3.7.2.4 Frame Loss Flag

The Frame Loss Flag is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the VCF Service that a sequence discontinuity has been detected, and that one or more Transfer Frames of the specified VC have been lost. If implemented, the flag shall be derived by examining the VC Frame Count in the Transfer Frames.

3.7.3 VCF SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.7.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) VCF.request;
- b) VCF.indication.

3.7.3.2 VCF.request

3.7.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the VCF Service user shall pass a VCF.request primitive to the service provider to request that a Frame be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified VC.

NOTE — The VCF.request primitive is the service request primitive for the VCF Service.

3.7.3.2.2 Semantics

The VCF.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VCF.request	(Frame, GVCID)
-------------	-------------------

3.7.3.2.3 When Generated

The VCF.request primitive shall be passed to the service provider to request it to send the Frame.

3.7.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the VCF.request primitive causes the service provider to transfer the Frame.

3.7.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The VCF.request primitive is used to convey Transfer Frames of a VC across the space link.

3.7.3.3 VCF.indication

3.7.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass a VCF.indication to the VCF Service user to deliver a frame.

NOTE – The VCF.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the VCF Service.

3.7.3.3.2 Semantics

The VCF.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

VCF.indication	(Frame, GVCID, Frame Loss Flag (optional))
----------------	--

3.7.3.3.3 When Generated

The VCF.indication primitive is passed from the service provider to the VCF Service user at the receiving end to deliver a Frame.

3.7.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the VCF.indication primitive by the VCF Service user is undefined.

3.7.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The VCF.indication primitive is used to deliver Transfer Frames of a VC to the VCF Service user identified by the GVCID.

3.8 MASTER CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE

3.8.1 OVERVIEW OF MASTER CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE

The MCF Service provides transfer of a sequence of fixed-length AOS Transfer Frames of an MC, created by an independent protocol entity, across a space link. The service is unidirectional, either asynchronous or periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but it may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to a receiving user.

Only one user can use this service on an MC, and the user is identified with the MCID of the MC. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one MC.

3.8.2 MASTER CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.8.2.1 General

The parameters used by the MCF Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.8.2.2 through 3.8.2.4.

3.8.2.2 Frame

The Frame parameter shall be an AOS Transfer Frame of the MC specified by the MCID parameter.

NOTES

- 1 The parameter Frame is the service data unit transferred by the VCF Service.
- 2 The format of the MCID parameter is defined in 4.1.
- 3 Restrictions on the AOS Transfer Frames transferred by the MCF Service are stated in 3.2.6.

3.8.2.3 Master Channel Identifier

The MCID parameter shall contain the MCID of the MC on which the Frame is to be transferred.

NOTE — The MCID is the SAP address of the MCF Service.

3.8.2.4 Frame Loss Flag

The Frame Loss Flag is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the MCF Service that a sequence discontinuity has been detected, and that one or more Transfer Frames of the specified MC may have been lost. If implemented, the flag shall be derived by a signal given by the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer.

NOTE – When more than one MC is used, the signal given by the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer cannot identify on which specific MC those frames have been lost.

3.8.3 MASTER CHANNEL FRAME SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.8.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) MCF.request;
- b) MCF.indication.

3.8.3.2 MCF.request

3.8.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the MCF Service user shall pass an MCF.request primitive to the service provider to request that a Frame be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified MC.

NOTE – The MCF.request primitive is the service request primitive for the MCF Service.

3.8.3.2.2 Semantics

The MCF.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

MCF.request	(Frame, MCID)
-------------	------------------

3.8.3.2.3 When Generated

The MCF.request primitive shall be passed to the service provider to request it to send the Frame.

3.8.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the MCF.request primitive shall cause the service provider to transfer the Frame.

3.8.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The MCF.request primitive shall be used to transfer Transfer Frames of an MC across the space link.

3.8.3.3 MCF.indication

3.8.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass an MCF.indication to the MCF Service user to deliver a Frame.

NOTE – The MCF.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the MCF Service.

3.8.3.3.2 Semantics

The MCF.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

MCF.indication	(Frame, MCID, Frame Loss Flag (optional))
----------------	---

3.8.3.3.3 When Generated

The MCF.indication primitive shall be passed from the service provider to the MCF Service user at the receiving end to deliver a Frame.

3.8.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the MCF.indication primitive by the MCF Service user is undefined.

3.8.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The MCF.indication primitive shall be used to deliver Transfer Frames of an MC to the VCF Service user identified by the MCID.

3.9 INSERT SERVICE

3.9.1 OVERVIEW OF INSERT SERVICE

The Insert Service provides transfer of private, fixed-length, octet-aligned service data units across a space link in a mode which efficiently utilizes the space link transmission resources at relatively low data rates. The service is unidirectional, periodic, and sequence-preserving. The service does not guarantee completeness, but may signal gaps in the sequence of service data units delivered to a receiving user.

Only one user can use this service on a Physical Channel and the user is identified with the Physical Channel Name of the Physical Channel. Service data units from different users are not multiplexed together within one Physical Channel.

3.9.2 INSERT SERVICE PARAMETERS

3.9.2.1 General

The parameters used by the Insert Service primitives shall conform to the specifications contained in subsections 3.9.2.2 through 3.9.2.4.

3.9.2.2 IN_SDU

The parameter IN_SDU shall be the service data unit transferred by the Insert Service.

NOTE – Restrictions on the IN_SDUs transferred by the Insert Service are stated in 3.2.7.

3.9.2.3 Physical Channel Name

The Physical Channel Name shall indicate the Physical Channel through which the IN_SDU is to be transferred.

NOTE – The Physical Channel Name is the SAP address of the Insert Service.

3.9.2.4 IN_SDU Loss Flag

The IN_SDU Loss Flag is an optional parameter that may be used to notify the user at the receiving end of the Insert Service that a sequence discontinuity has been detected, and that one or more IN_SDUs have been lost. If implemented, the flag shall be derived by a signal given by the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer.

3.9.3 INSERT SERVICE PRIMITIVES

3.9.3.1 General

The service primitives associated with this service are:

- a) INSERT.request;
- b) INSERT.indication.

3.9.3.2 INSERT.request

3.9.3.2.1 Function

At the sending end, the Insert Service user shall pass an INSERT.request primitive to the service provider to request that an IN_SDU be transferred to the user at the receiving end through the specified Physical Channel.

NOTE – The INSERT.request primitive is the service request primitive for the Insert Service.

3.9.3.2.2 Semantics

The INSERT.request primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

INSERT.request	(IN_SDU, Physical Channel Name)
----------------	------------------------------------

3.9.3.2.3 When Generated

The INSERT.request primitive is passed to the service provider to request it to send the IN_SDU.

3.9.3.2.4 Effect On Receipt

Receipt of the INSERT.request primitive causes the service provider to transfer the IN_SDU.

3.9.3.2.5 Additional Comments

The INSERT.request primitive is used to transfer IN_SDUs across the space link on the specified Physical Channel.

3.9.3.3 INSERT.indication

3.9.3.3.1 Function

At the receiving end, the service provider shall pass an INSERT.indication to the Insert Service user to deliver an IN_SDU.

NOTE – The INSERT.indication primitive is the service indication primitive for the Insert Service.

3.9.3.3.2 Semantics

The INSERT.indication primitive shall provide parameters as follows:

INSERT.indication	(IN_SDU, Physical Channel Name, IN_SDU Loss Flag (optional))
-------------------	--

3.9.3.3.3 When Generated

The INSERT.indication primitive shall be passed from the service provider to the Insert Service user at the receiving end to deliver an IN_SDU.

3.9.3.3.4 Effect On Receipt

The effect of receipt of the INSERT.indication primitive by the Insert Service user is undefined.

3.9.3.3.5 Additional Comments

The INSERT.indication primitive shall be used to deliver IN_SDUs to the Insert Service user identified by the Physical Channel Name.

4 PROTOCOL SPECIFICATION WITHOUT SDLS OPTION

This section specifies the protocol data unit and the procedures of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol without support for the SDLS protocol. Section 6 specifies the protocol with the SDLS option.

4.1 PROTOCOL DATA UNIT

4.1.1 AOS TRANSFER FRAME

4.1.1.1 An AOS Transfer Frame shall encompass the major fields, positioned contiguously, in the following sequence:

- a) Transfer Frame Primary Header (6 octets or 8 octets; mandatory);
- b) Transfer Frame Insert Zone (integral number of octets; optional);
- c) Transfer Frame Data Field (integral number of octets; mandatory);
- d) Operational Control Field (4 octets; optional);
- e) Frame Error Control Field (2 octets, optional).

4.1.1.2 The AOS Transfer Frame shall be of constant length throughout a specific Mission Phase for any VC or MC on a Physical Channel. Its length shall be consistent with the specifications contained in references [3], [4], and [5]. The structural components of the AOS Transfer Frame are shown in figure 4-1.

NOTES

- 1 The protocol data unit of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol is the AOS Transfer Frame. In this Recommended Standard, the AOS Transfer Frame is also called the Transfer Frame or Frame for simplicity.
- 2 The combination of the OCF and the Frame Error Control Field is called the Transfer Frame Trailer.
- 3 The start of the Transfer Frame is signaled by the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer.
- 4 A change of Transfer Frame Length may result in a loss of synchronization at the receiver.

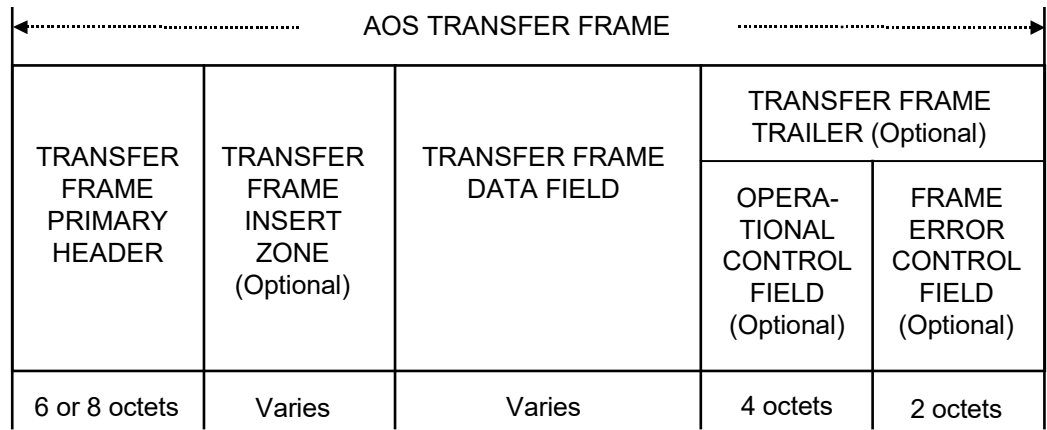


Figure 4-1: AOS Transfer Frame Structural Components

4.1.2 TRANSFER FRAME PRIMARY HEADER

4.1.2.1 General

The Transfer Frame Primary Header is mandatory and shall consist of six fields in the following sequence:

- 1. Master Channel Identifier (12 bits; mandatory);
- 2. Virtual Channel Identifier (6 bits; mandatory);
- 3. Virtual Channel Frame Count (3 octets; mandatory);
- 4. Signaling Field (2 bits; mandatory);
- 5. Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle (4 bits; mandatory);
- 6. Frame Header Error Control (2 octets, optional).

NOTE – MCID is the concatenation of three non-contiguous fields: Transfer Frame Version Number (2 bits) + Spacecraft ID (MSB) (2 bits) + Spacecraft ID (LSB) (8 bits).

The format of the Transfer Frame Primary Header is shown in figure 4-2.

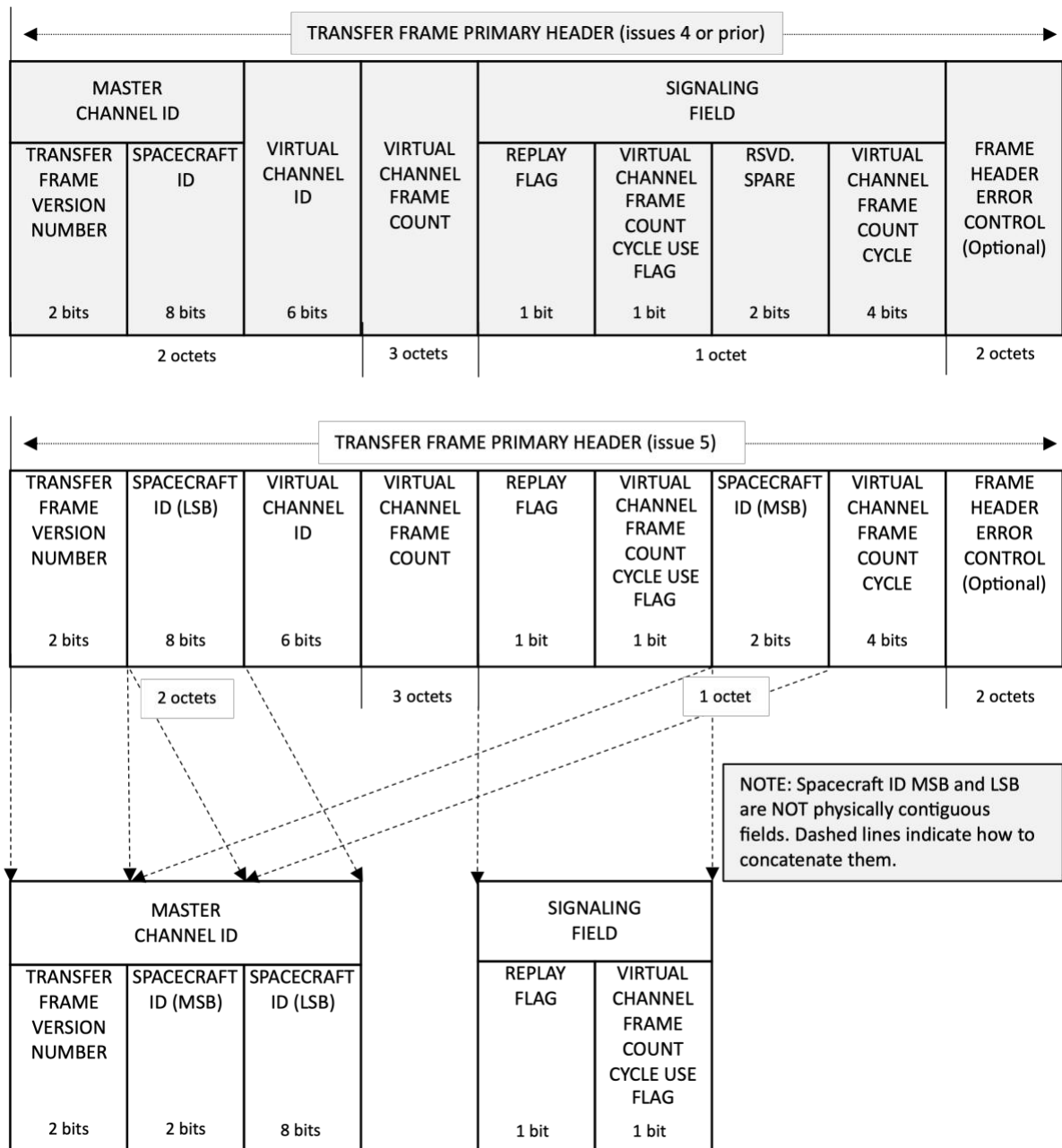


Figure 4-2: Transfer Frame Primary Header

4.1.2.2 Master Channel Identifier

4.1.2.2.1 General

4.1.2.2.1.1 Bits 0–9 and Bits 42–43 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the 12-bit MCID.

4.1.2.2.1.2 The Master Channel Identifier shall consist of:

- a) Transfer Frame Version Number (2 bits, mandatory);
- b) Spacecraft ID + Spacecraft ID MSB (10 bits, mandatory).

NOTE – Missions implementing CCSDS 732.0-B (AOS) issue 4 or earlier define the Spacecraft Identifier as only the 8 least significant bits and therefore have a 10-bit MCID. See 4.1.2.2.3.

4.1.2.2.2 Transfer Frame Version Number

4.1.2.2.2.1 Bits 0–1 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the (Binary Encoded) Transfer Frame Version Number.

4.1.2.2.2.2 This 2-bit field shall identify the data unit as a Transfer Frame defined by this Recommended Standard; it shall be set to ‘01’.

NOTE – This Recommended Standard defines the AOS Version 2 Transfer Frame, whose binary encoded Version Number is ‘01’.

4.1.2.2.3 Spacecraft Identifier

4.1.2.2.3.1 Bits 2-9 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the 8 least significant bits (LSB) of the Spacecraft Identifier (SCID).

4.1.2.2.3.2 Bits 42-43 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the 2 most significant bits (MSB) of the SCID.

NOTES

- 1 For AOS (732.0-B) issue 5 and higher, the Version 2 SCID is 10 bits in length. For previous issues, it is 8 bits, and bits 42-43 are defined as reserved spare and set to ‘00’.
- 2 The Space Assigned Numbers Authority (SANA) assigns Spacecraft Identifiers according to the procedures in reference [7].

4.1.2.3 Virtual Channel Identifier

4.1.2.3.1 Bits 10–15 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Virtual Channel Identifier (VCID).

4.1.2.3.2 The VCID shall be used to identify the VC.

NOTES

- 1 If only one VC is used, these bits are set permanently to value ‘all zeros’. A VC used for transmission of Only Idle Data (OID) Transfer Frames (i.e., frames whose Data

Fields contain only idle data—see 4.1.4) is indicated by setting these bits to the reserved value of ‘all ones’.

- 2 There are no restrictions on the selection of VCIDs except the rules described above. In particular, VCs are not required to be numbered consecutively.
- 3 A Transfer Frame on the ‘Idle’ VC may not contain any valid user data within its Transfer Frame Data Field, but it must contain the Insert Zone if the Insert Service is supported.

4.1.2.4 Virtual Channel Frame Count

4.1.2.4.1 Bits 16–39 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Virtual Channel Frame Count.

4.1.2.4.2 This 24-bit field shall contain a sequential binary count (modulo-16,777,216) of each Transfer Frame transmitted within a specific VC.

4.1.2.4.3 A resetting of the Virtual Channel Frame Count before reaching 16,777,215 shall not take place unless it is unavoidable.

NOTE – The purpose of this field is to provide individual accountability for each VC, primarily to enable systematic Packet extraction from the Transfer Frame Data Field. If the VC Frame Count is reset because of an unavoidable re-initialization, the completeness of a sequence of Transfer Frames in the related VC cannot be determined.

4.1.2.5 Signaling Field

4.1.2.5.1 General

4.1.2.5.1.1 Bits 40–41 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Signaling Field.

4.1.2.5.1.2 The Signaling Field shall be used to alert the receiver of the Transfer Frames with respect to functions that: (a) may change more rapidly than can be handled by management, or; (b) provide a significant cross-check against manual or automated setups for fault detection and isolation purposes.

4.1.2.5.1.3 This 2-bit field shall be subdivided into two sub-fields as follows:

- a) Replay Flag (1 bit, mandatory);
- b) Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle Use Flag (1 bit, mandatory).

4.1.2.5.2 Replay Flag

4.1.2.5.2.1 Bit 40 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Replay Flag.

4.1.2.5.2.2 Recognizing the need to store Transfer Frames during periods when the space link is unavailable and to retrieve them for subsequent replay when the link is restored, this flag shall alert the receiver of the Transfer Frames with respect to its 'realtime' or 'replay' status. Its main purpose is to discriminate between realtime and replay Transfer Frames when they both may use the same VC.

4.1.2.5.2.3 The Replay Flag is interpreted as follows:

- a) '0' = Realtime Transfer Frame;
- b) '1' = Replay Transfer Frame.

NOTES

- 1 Owing to the wide spectrum of onboard storage and retrieval technology options, the exact interpretation of this Flag is necessarily the subject of negotiation between projects and cross-support organizations. For instance, it may be interpreted to indicate that the value of the Virtual Channel Frame Count field on the replayed VC decreases, rather than increases, as a function of reverse playback.
- 2 If Transfer Frames are stored after encoding by the Channel Coding Sublayer, they must be re-encoded if the status of the Replay Flag is altered after retrieval.

4.1.2.5.3 Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle Use Flag

4.1.2.5.3.1 Bit 41 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle Use Flag.

4.1.2.5.3.2 This one-bit field shall indicate whether the Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle field is used; its value shall be interpreted as follows:

- a) '0' = Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle field is not used and shall be ignored by the receiver;
- b) '1' = Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle field is used and shall be interpreted by the receiver.

4.1.2.5.4 Spacecraft Identifier (MSB)

4.1.2.5.4.1 Bits 42-43 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the 2 mandatory most significant bits (MSB) of the Spacecraft ID.

NOTE — Missions implementing CCSDS 732.0-B (AOS) issue 4 or earlier set this field to '00'.

4.1.2.5.4.2 The interpretation of this field and the issue 5 and higher 10-bit Spacecraft Identifier is defined in section 4.1.2.2.3.

4.1.2.5.5 Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle

4.1.2.5.5.1 If used, bits 44-47 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle field.

4.1.2.5.5.2 Each time the Virtual Channel Frame Count returns to zero, the Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle shall be incremented.

NOTE — The Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle effectively extends the Virtual Channel Frame Count from 24 to 28 bits.

4.1.2.5.5.3 If not used, bits 44 through 47 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall be set to 'all zeros'.

4.1.2.6 Frame Header Error Control

4.1.2.6.1 If implemented, Bits 48-63 of the Transfer Frame Primary Header shall contain the Frame Header Error Control.

NOTES

- 1 The 12-bit MCID, 6-bit VCID, 2-bit Signaling Field, and 4-bit Virtual Channel Frame Count Cycle Field may all be protected by an optional error detecting and correcting code, whose check symbols are contained within this 16-bit field. Whether this field should be used on a particular Physical Channel is determined based on mission requirements for data quality and selected options for the Channel Coding Sublayer.
- 2 The Virtual Channel Frame Count from bit 16 to bit 39 is not protected.

4.1.2.6.2 The presence or absence of the optional Frame Header Error Control shall be established by management.

4.1.2.6.3 If present, the Frame Header Error Control shall exist in every Transfer Frame transmitted within the same Physical Channel.

4.1.2.6.4 Once set by management, the presence or absence of the Frame Header Error Control shall be static throughout a Mission Phase.

4.1.2.6.5 The mechanism for generating the Frame Header Error Control shall be a Reed-Solomon (15, 11) code over GF(2⁴), shortened by 5 symbols and converted to GF(2), to form a binary (40, 24) code. The parameters of the selected code are as follows:

- a) 'J=4' bits per Reed-Solomon (R-S) symbol.
- b) 'E=2' symbol error correction capability within an R-S code word.
- c) The field generator polynomial shall be:

$$F(X) = x^4 + x + 1$$

over GF(2)

- d) The code generator polynomial shall be:

$$g(x) = (x + \alpha^6)(x + \alpha^7)(x + \alpha^8)(x + \alpha^9)$$

over GF(2⁴)

where $F(\alpha) = 0$,

$$\alpha^6 = 1100, \alpha^7 = 1011$$

$$\alpha^8 = 0101, \alpha^9 = 1010$$

also:

$$g(x) = x^4 + \alpha^3 x^3 + \alpha x^2 + \alpha^3 x + 1$$

over GF(2⁴)

and:

$$\alpha^0 = 0001, \alpha^3 = 1000$$

$$\alpha = 0010$$

- e) Within an R-S symbol, the transmission shall start from the bit on the left side; e.g.,

$$\alpha^3 = 1000$$

shall be transmitted as a 1 followed by three 0s.

- f) Five symbols of virtual fill shall be used to logically complete the Reed-Solomon codeword. This virtual fill shall:
 - 1) consist of all zeros;
 - 2) not be transmitted;

- 3) be inserted only at the beginning of the codeword.
- g) The selected code is a systematic code.
- h) The bit to R-S symbol mapping shall be:

<u>bits in the header</u>	<u>symbol</u>	<u>function</u>
—	1	virtual fill
—	2	virtual fill
—	3	virtual fill
—	4	virtual fill
—	5	virtual fill
0,1,2,3	6	systematic symbol
4,5,6,7	7	systematic symbol
8,9,10,11	8	systematic symbol
12,13,14,15	9	systematic symbol
40,41,42,43	10	systematic symbol
44,45,46,47	11	systematic symbol
48,49,50,51	12	parity symbol
52,53,54,55	13	parity symbol
56,57,58,59	14	parity symbol
60,61,62,63	15	parity symbol

NOTES

- 1 The purpose of this field is to provide a capability for protecting some key elements in the Transfer Frame Primary Header.
- 2 Whether this field should be used on a particular Physical Channel is determined based on the mission requirements for data quality and the selected options for the Channel Coding Sublayer.
- 3 The header error correction code can correct up to and including two-symbol errors. This is sufficient to meet the performance of $<10^{-7}$ Data Fields missing at a 10^{-5} channel bit error rate for random bit errors. In the case of convolutional coded channels, in particular when the convolutional coding is interleaved, the Data Field loss rate will drop to 2×10^{-5} at an operating point equivalent to a channel bit error rate of 10^{-5} . This is the result of the burst errors typical of the convolutional decoders.

4.1.3 TRANSFER FRAME INSERT ZONE

4.1.3.1 If implemented, the Transfer Frame Insert Zone shall follow, without gap, the Transfer Frame Primary Header.

4.1.3.2 The presence or absence of the optional Transfer Frame Insert Zone shall be established by management.

4.1.3.3 If the Physical Channel supports the Insert Service for transfer of periodic data, then the Insert Zone shall exist in every Transfer Frame transmitted within the same Physical Channel, including OID Transfer Frames.

4.1.3.4 Once set by management, the presence or absence of the Insert Zone shall be static throughout a Mission Phase.

4.1.3.4.1 The length of the Insert Zone shall be set by management to be equal to the constant length of the Insert Service Data Unit (IN_SDU) for that Physical Channel. The Insert Zone shall contain precisely one octet-aligned IN_SDU.

4.1.3.4.2 Once set by management, the length of the Insert Zone shall be static throughout a Mission Phase.

NOTE – If the Insert Zone is present, management reduces the length of the Transfer Frame Data Field that is available to other service users by an amount equal to the constant length of the Insert Zone.

4.1.4 TRANSFER FRAME DATA FIELD

4.1.4.1 Overview

4.1.4.1.1 The Transfer Frame Data Field shall follow, without gap, the Transfer Frame Primary Header or the Transfer Frame Insert Zone, if present.

4.1.4.1.2 The Transfer Frame Data Field, which shall contain an integer number of octets, shall have a length which varies and is equal to:

- a) the fixed Transfer Frame length selected for use on a particular Physical Channel; minus
- b) the length of the Transfer Frame Primary Header plus the length of the Transfer Frame Insert Zone and/or the Transfer Frame Trailer (if any of these are present).

4.1.4.1.3 The Transfer Frame Data Field shall contain one Multiplexing Protocol Data Unit (M_PDU), one Bitstream Protocol Data Unit (B_PDU), one Virtual Channel Access Service Data Unit (VCA_SDU), or Idle Data.

4.1.4.1.4 M_PDUs, B_PDUs, VCA_SDUs, and Idle Data shall not be mixed in a VC (i.e., if a VC transfers M_PDUs, every Transfer Frame of that VC shall contain an M_PDU). Management shall decide whether M_PDUs, B_PDUs or VCA_SDUs are transferred on a particular VC, and this decision shall remain static throughout a Mission Phase.

4.1.4.1.5 In the case where no valid Transfer Frame Data Field is available for transmission at release time for a Transfer Frame, a Transfer Frame with a Data Field containing only Idle Data shall be transmitted. Such a Transfer Frame is called an OID Transfer Frame.

4.1.4.1.5.1 The VCID of an OID Transfer Frame shall be set to the value of ‘all ones’.

4.1.4.1.5.2 The Transfer Frame Data Field of an OID Transfer Frame shall be filled in by the mandatory Pseudo Noise sequence generated by a 32-cell Linear Feedback Shift Register (LFSR) with polynomial $D^0 + D^1 + D^2 + D^{22} + D^{32}$.

NOTE – Annex D contains example implementations of this LFSR.

4.1.4.1.5.2.1 An LFSR that follows the Fibonacci form (see figure D-1) shall be initialized at device start-up with an ‘all-ones’ seed and shall not be restarted.

4.1.4.1.5.2.2 An LFSR that follows the Galois form (see figure D-2) shall be initialized at device start-up with a ‘00000000001111111111111111111101’ seed and shall not be restarted.

NOTES

- 1 Transfer Frames containing Idle Data in their Data Fields are sent to maintain synchronization at the receiver and to transmit data in the Transfer Frame Insert Zone when there is no Data Field to send.
- 2 Idle Data in the Transfer Frame Data Field of an OID Transfer Frame must not be confused with the Idle Packet specified in reference [8].
- 3 A random pattern is used in the OID Transfer Frame Data Field to avoid frame-reception problems resulting from insufficient randomization.

4.1.4.2 Multiplexing Protocol Data Unit

4.1.4.2.1 Overview

4.1.4.2.1.1 The M_PDU shall follow, without gap, the Transfer Frame Primary Header or the Transfer Frame Insert Zone if present.

4.1.4.2.1.2 The length of the M_PDU shall be fixed by management for any particular VC, since it is required to fit exactly within the fixed-length Transfer Frame Data Field.

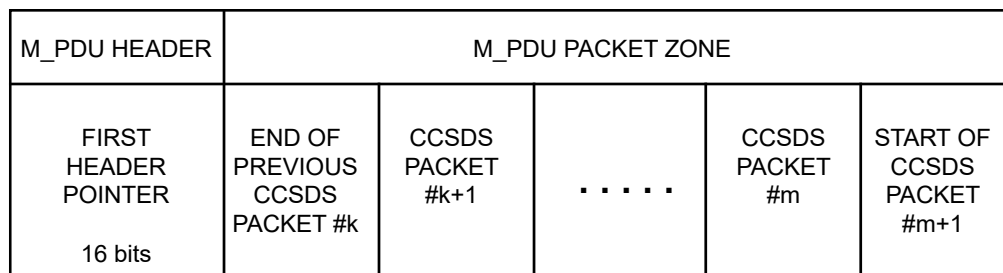
NOTE – The length of M_PDUs carried by a Physical Channel which supports the Insert Service must take into account the fixed length of the optional Insert Zone.

4.1.4.2.1.3 The M_PDU shall be divided as follows:

- a) M_PDU Header (2 octets, mandatory);
- b) M_PDU Packet Zone (integral number of octets, mandatory).

4.1.4.2.1.4 The M_PDU Header shall contain the First Header Pointer (16 bits, mandatory).

4.1.4.2.1.5 The format of the M_PDU is shown in figure 4-3.

**Figure 4-3: Multiplexing Protocol Data Unit (M_PDU)****4.1.4.2.2 First Header Pointer**

4.1.4.2.2.1 Bits 0–15 of the M_PDU Header shall contain the First Header Pointer.

4.1.4.2.2.2 The First Header Pointer shall contain the position of the first octet of the first Packet that starts in the M_PDU Packet Zone.

4.1.4.2.2.3 The locations of the octets in the M_PDU Packet Zone shall be numbered in ascending order. The first octet in this zone is assigned the number 0. The First Header Pointer shall contain the binary representation of the location of the first octet of the first Packet that starts in the M_PDU Packet Zone.

NOTES

- 1 The purpose of the First Header Pointer is to facilitate delimiting of variable-length Packets contained within the M_PDU Packet Zone, by pointing directly to the location of the first Packet from which its length may be determined.
- 2 The locations of any subsequent Packets within the same M_PDU Packet Zone will be determined by calculating the locations using the length field of these Packets.
- 3 If the last Packet in the M_PDU Packet Zone of Transfer Frame *N* spills over into Frame *M* of the same VC ($N < M$), then the First Header Pointer in Frame *M* ignores the residue of the split Packet and indicates the start of the next Packet that starts in Frame *M*.

4.1.4.2.2.4 If no Packet starts in the M_PDU Packet Zone, the First Header Pointer shall be set to ‘all ones’.

NOTE – The above situation may occur if a long Packet extends across more than one Transfer Frame.

4.1.4.2.2.5 If the M_PDU Packet Zone contains only Idle Data, the First Header Pointer shall be set to ‘all ones minus one’.

4.1.4.2.3 M_PDU Packet Zone

4.1.4.2.3.1 The M_PDU Packet Zone shall follow, without gap, the M_PDU Header.

4.1.4.2.3.2 The M_PDU Packet Zone shall contain either Packets or Idle Data (a project-specified 'idle' pattern).

NOTE – The idle pattern used in the M_PDU is project-specific and can be of fixed or variable length. A random pattern is preferred. Problems with the reception of frames have been encountered because of insufficient randomization.

4.1.4.2.3.3 Packets shall be inserted contiguously and in forward order into the M_PDU Packet Zone.

NOTE – The first and last Packets of the M_PDU are not necessarily complete, since the first Packet may be a continuation of a Packet begun in the previous M_PDU, and the last Packet may continue in the subsequent M_PDU of the same VC.

4.1.4.2.3.4 When insufficient Packets (including Idle Packets) are available at release time of a Transfer Frame of a VC carrying M_PDUs, an M_PDU that contains only Idle Data in its Packet Zone shall be generated.

NOTES

- 1 M_PDUs that contain only Idle Data in their Packet Zones are sent to maintain synchronous transmission of Transfer Frames and also to transmit data in the OCF on a specific VC when there is no Packet to send.
- 2 An M_PDU that contains only Idle Data in its Packet Zone can be generated whenever it is necessary (even in the middle of transmission of a Packet that is split into multiple M_PDUs).
- 3 An M_PDU that contains only Idle Data in its Packet Zone must not be confused with the OID Transfer Frame defined in [4.1.4.1.5](#).
- 4 Idle Data in the M_PDU Packet Zone should not be confused with the Idle Packet specified in reference [8].

4.1.4.3 Bitstream Protocol Data Unit

4.1.4.3.1 Overview

4.1.4.3.1.1 The Bitstream Protocol Data Unit (B_PDU) shall follow, without gap, the Transfer Frame Primary Header or the Transfer Frame Insert Zone if present.

4.1.4.3.1.2 The length of the B_PDU shall be fixed by management for any particular VC, since it is required to fit exactly within the fixed-length Transfer Frame Data Field.

NOTE – The length of B_PDUs carried by a Physical Channel which supports the Insert Service must take into account the fixed length of the optional Insert Zone.

4.1.4.3.1.3 The B_PDU shall be divided as follows:

- a) B_PDU Header (2 octets, mandatory);
- b) B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone (integral number of octets, mandatory).

4.1.4.3.1.4 The B_PDU Header shall be subdivided as follows:

- a) Reserved Spare (2 bits, mandatory);
- b) Bitstream Data Pointer (14 bits, mandatory).

4.1.4.3.1.5 The format of the B_PDU is shown in figure 4-4.

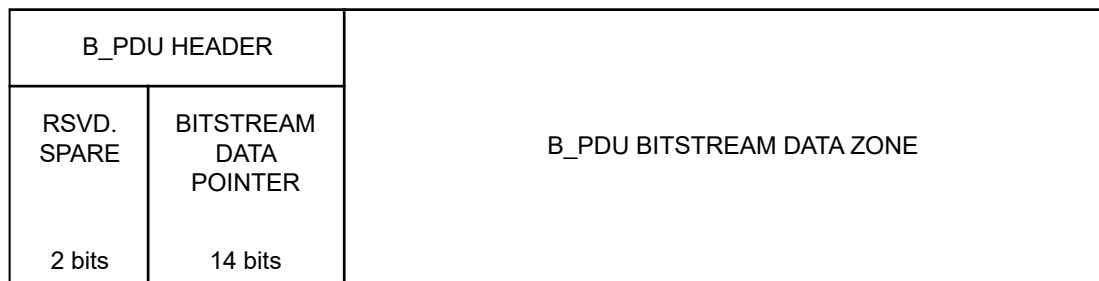


Figure 4-4: Bitstream Protocol Data Unit (B_PDU)

4.1.4.3.2 Reserved Spare

4.1.4.3.2.1 Bits 0–1 of the B_PDU Header shall contain the Reserved Spare.

4.1.4.3.2.2 This two-bit Reserved Spare field is currently undefined by CCSDS; by convention, it shall therefore be set to the reserved value of ‘00’.

4.1.4.3.3 Bitstream Data Pointer

4.1.4.3.3.1 Bits 2–15 of the B_PDU Header shall contain the Bitstream Data Pointer.

NOTE – Because it may be necessary to insert idle data if an insufficient number of Bitstream Data bits have been received before a B_PDU is released for transmission, the Bitstream Data Pointer indicates the location of the last valid user data bit within the B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone (i.e., the boundary between user data and any inserted idle data).

4.1.4.3.3.2 The locations of the bits in the B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone shall be numbered in ascending order. The first bit in this zone is assigned the number 0. The Bitstream Data Pointer shall contain the binary representation of the location of the last valid user data bit within B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone.

4.1.4.3.3.3 If there are no idle data in the Bitstream Data Zone (i.e., the B_PDU contains only valid user data), the Bitstream Data Pointer shall be set to the value ‘all ones’.

4.1.4.3.3.4 If there are no valid user data in the Bitstream Data Zone (i.e., the B_PDU contains only idle data), the Bitstream Data Pointer shall be set to the value ‘all ones minus one’.

NOTE – The Bit Stream Service User should be aware that the maximum transfer frame size when using the Bit Stream Service is limited to 16384 bits due to the limitation of the B_PDU header Bit Stream Data Pointer.

4.1.4.3.4 B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone

4.1.4.3.4.1 The B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone shall follow, without gap, the B_PDU Header.

4.1.4.3.4.2 The Bitstream Data Zone shall contain either a fixed-length block of the user Bitstream Data (possibly terminated with idle data at a location delimited by the Bitstream Data Pointer), or Idle Data (a fixed-length project-specified ‘idle’ pattern).

4.1.4.3.4.3 When no Bitstream Data are available at release time of a Transfer Frame of a VC carrying B_PDUs, a B_PDU that contains only Idle Data in its Data Zone shall be generated.

NOTES

- 1 B_PDUs that contain only Idle Data in its Data Zone are sent to maintain synchronous transmission of Transfer Frames and to transmit data in the OCF on a specific VC when there are no Bitstream Data to send.
- 2 A B_PDU that contains only Idle Data in its Data Zone must not be confused with the OID Transfer Frame defined in 4.1.4.

4.1.5 OPERATIONAL CONTROL FIELD

4.1.5.1 If present, the OCF shall occupy the four octets following, without gap, the Transfer Frame Data Field.

4.1.5.2 The OCF is optional; its presence or absence is established by management for each VC.

4.1.5.3 If the OCF is present on a VC, it shall occur within every Transfer Frame transmitted through the VC throughout a Mission Phase.

4.1.5.4 Bit 0 of the OCF shall contain a Type Flag with the following meanings:

- a) the Type Flag shall be ‘0’ if the OCF holds a Type-1-Report which shall contain a Communications Link Control Word, the content of which is defined in reference [C6];

- b) the Type Flag shall be '1' if the OCF holds a Type-2-Report.

NOTE – The Type Flag may vary between Transfer Frames on the same VC that carries this field.

4.1.5.5 In a Type-2 Report, bit 1 of the OCF shall indicate the use of this report as follows:

- a) if this bit is '0', the contents of the report are project-specific;
- b) if this bit is '1', the report contains an SDLS FSR as defined in reference [11].

NOTES

- 1 In Type-2 Reports, the value of bit 1 of the OCF may vary between Transfer Frames on the same VC that carries this field.
- 2 The purpose of this field is to provide a standardized mechanism for reporting a small number of real-time functions (such as supporting the reporting mechanism of the Communications Operation Procedure (COP)-1 retransmission control procedure or the SDLS security protocol); currently the use for retransmission control (Type-1 Reports) has been defined by CCSDS in reference [C6] for COP-1 CLC Communications Link Control Word, and the use for security report (Type-2 Reports) has been defined by CCSDS in reference [11] for SDLS Frame Security Reports.
- 3 It is up to the spacecraft designer to ensure that VCs carrying OCFs are transmitted frequently enough not to disrupt the intended behavior of the COP in use, which may time out if OCFs are not delivered in a timely fashion.

4.1.6 FRAME ERROR CONTROL FIELD

4.1.6.1 General

4.1.6.1.1 If present, the Frame Error Control Field shall occupy the two octets following, without gap, the OCF (if present) or the Transfer Frame Data Field (if an OCF is absent).

4.1.6.1.2 The Frame Error Control Field is optional; its presence or absence shall be established by management.

4.1.6.1.3 If present, the Frame Error Control Field shall occur within every Transfer Frame transmitted within the same Physical Channel throughout a Mission Phase.

NOTES

- 1 The purpose of this field is to provide a capability for detecting errors which may have been introduced into the Transfer Frame during the transmission and data handling process.

- 2 Whether this field should be used on a particular Physical Channel is determined based on the mission requirements for data quality and the selected options for the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer. This field may be mandatory depending on the selected options for the Channel Coding Sublayer.

4.1.6.2 Frame Error Control Field Encoding Procedure

4.1.6.2.1 The Frame Error Control Field is computed by applying Cyclic Redundancy Check (CRC) techniques. The Encoding Procedure shall accept an $(n-16)$ -bit Transfer Frame, excluding the Frame Error Control Field and generate a systematic binary $(n, n-16)$ block code by appending a 16-bit Frame Error Control Field as the final 16 bits of the codeblock, where n is the length of the Transfer Frame.

NOTE – The Bit Numbering Convention as specified in 1.6.2 is applicable below.

4.1.6.2.2 The equation for the contents of the Frame Error Control Field is:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{FECF} &= [(X^{16} \cdot M(X)) + (X^{(n-16)} \cdot L(X))] \text{ modulo } G(X) \\ &= P_0 \cdot X^{15} + P_1 \cdot X^{14} + P_2 \cdot X^{13} + \dots + P_{14} \cdot X^1 + P_{15} \cdot X^0 \end{aligned}$$

where

- all arithmetic is modulo 2;
- FECF is the 16-bit Frame Error Control Field with the first bit transferred being the most significant bit P_0 taken as the coefficient of the highest power of X ;
- n is the number of bits in the encoded message;
- $M(X)$ is the $(n-16)$ -bit information message to be encoded expressed as a polynomial with binary coefficients, with the first bit transferred being the most significant bit M_0 taken as the coefficient of the highest power of X ;
- $L(X)$ is the presetting polynomial given by

$$L(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{15} X^i ;$$

- $G(X)$ is the generating polynomial given by

$$G(X) = X^{16} + X^{12} + X^5 + 1.$$

NOTES

- 1 The $X^{(n-16)} \cdot L(X)$ term has the effect of presetting the shift register to all '1' state prior to encoding.

- 2 A possible FECF generator implementation is shown in figure 4-5. For each frame, the shift register cells are initialized to '1'. The ganged switch is in position 1 while the information bits are being transferred and in position 2 for the sixteen FECF bits.

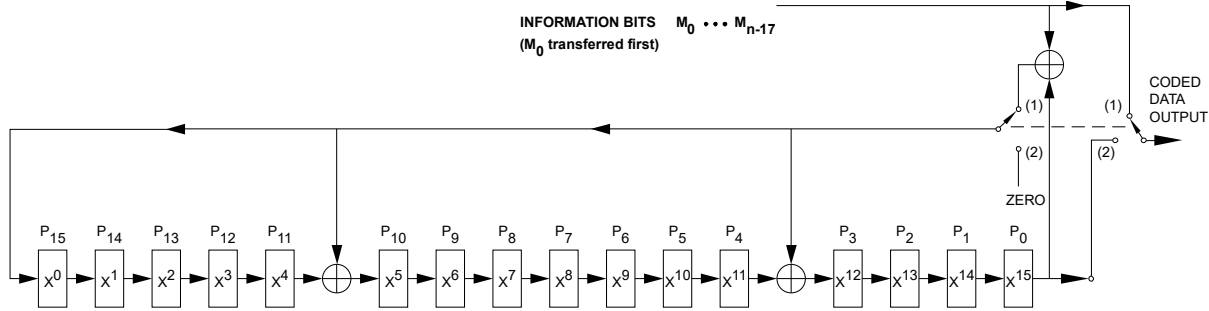


Figure 4-5: Logic Diagram of the Encoder

4.1.6.3 Frame Error Control Field Decoding Procedure

The error detection syndrome, $S(X)$, is given by

$$S(X) = [(X^{16} \cdot C^*(X)) + (X^n \cdot L(X))] \text{ modulo } G(X)$$

where

- $C^*(X)$ is the received block, including the Frame Error Control Field, in polynomial form, with the first bit transferred being the most significant bit C_0^* taken as the coefficient of the highest power of X ; and
- $S(X)$ is the syndrome polynomial which will be zero if no error is detected and non-zero if an error is detected, with the most significant bit S_0 taken as the coefficient of the highest power of X .

The received block $C^*(X)$ equals the transmitted codeblock $C(X)$ plus (modulo two) the n -bit error block $E(X)$, $C^*(X) = C(X) + E(X)$, where both are expressed as polynomials of the same form, i.e., with the most significant bit C_0 or E_0 taken as the binary coefficient of the highest power of X .

NOTE – A possible syndrome polynomial generator implementation is shown in figure 4-6. For each frame, the shift register cells are initialized to '1'. The frame includes n bits, i.e., $(n-16)$ information message bits plus the 16 bits of the FECF. All the n bits of the frame are clocked into the input and then the storage stages are examined. For an error-free block, the contents of the shift register cells will be 'zero'. A non-zero content indicates an erroneous block.

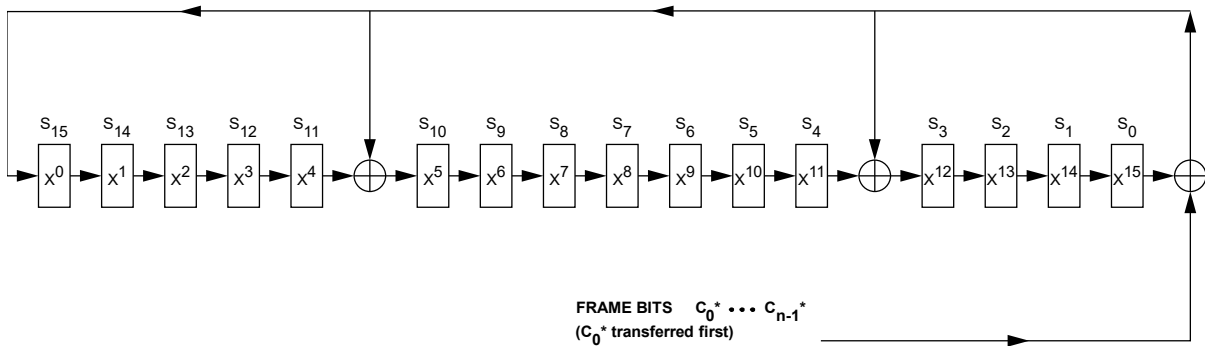


Figure 4-6: Logic Diagram of the Decoder

4.2 PROTOCOL PROCEDURES AT SENDING END

4.2.1 OVERVIEW

This subsection describes procedures at the sending end associated with each of the functions shown in figure 4-7. In this figure, data flow from top to bottom of the figure. This figure identifies data-handling functions performed by the protocol entity at the sending end and shows logical relationships among these functions. This figure is not intended to imply any hardware or software configuration in a real system. Depending on the services actually used for a real system, not all of the functions may be present in the protocol entity. The procedures described in this subsection are defined in an abstract sense and are not intended to imply any particular implementation approach of a protocol entity.

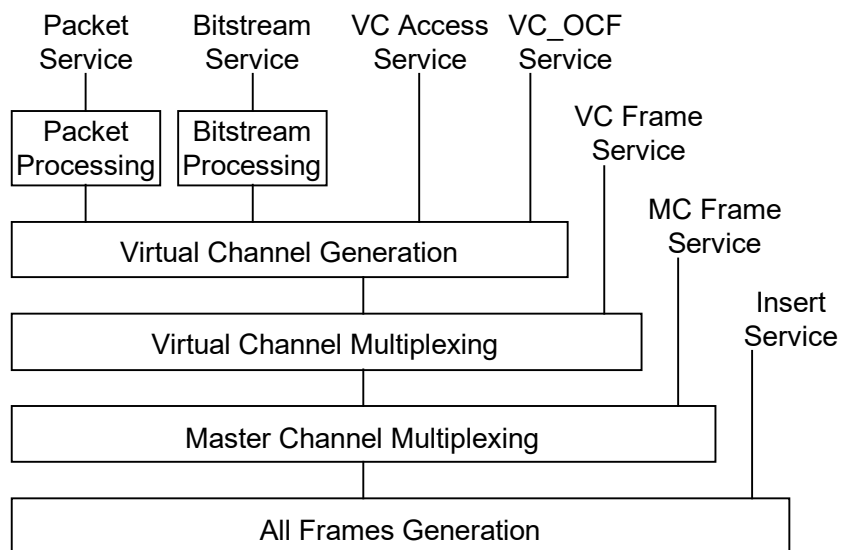


Figure 4-7: Internal Organization of Protocol Entity (Sending End)

4.2.2 PACKET PROCESSING FUNCTION

4.2.2.1 The Packet Processing Function shall be used to transfer variable-length Packets in the fixed-length M_PDU of Transfer Frames.

NOTE – There is an instance of the Packet Processing Function for each VC that carries Packets.

4.2.2.2 The M_PDUs shall be constructed by concatenating Packets together until the maximum M_PDU length is exceeded. Any Packet that exceeds the maximum M_PDU length shall be split, filling the M_PDU completely and starting a new M_PDU on the same VC with the remainder. Construction of the next M_PDU shall continue with the concatenation of Packets until it overflows.

4.2.2.3 If Packets of multiple versions are to be transferred on a VC, Packets of these versions shall be multiplexed into a contiguous string of Packets before constructing M_PDUs.

4.2.2.4 The ‘First Header Pointer’ field shall be set to indicate the location of the first octet of the first Packet occurring within the M_PDU Packet Zone.

4.2.2.5 In the absence of sufficient Packets supplied from the users at release time, one or more Idle Packets of appropriate lengths may be created, where an Idle Packet is either

- an Idle Packet defined by reference [8], or
- an Encapsulation Idle Packet defined by reference [9].

NOTE – The shortest Idle Packet defined by reference [8] is 7-octets long (i.e., a 6-octet header plus 1 octet of idle data). If the area to be filled in an M_PDU is less than 7 octets, then the Idle Packet will spill over into the beginning of the next M_PDU. The shortest Encapsulation Idle Packet defined by reference [9] is one octet in length (i.e., a one-octet header).

4.2.2.6 If it is necessary, the Packet Processing Function may generate an ‘idle’ M_PDU by setting the First Header Pointer to ‘all ones minus one’.

NOTE – An abstract model of the Packet Processing Function is illustrated in figure 4-8.

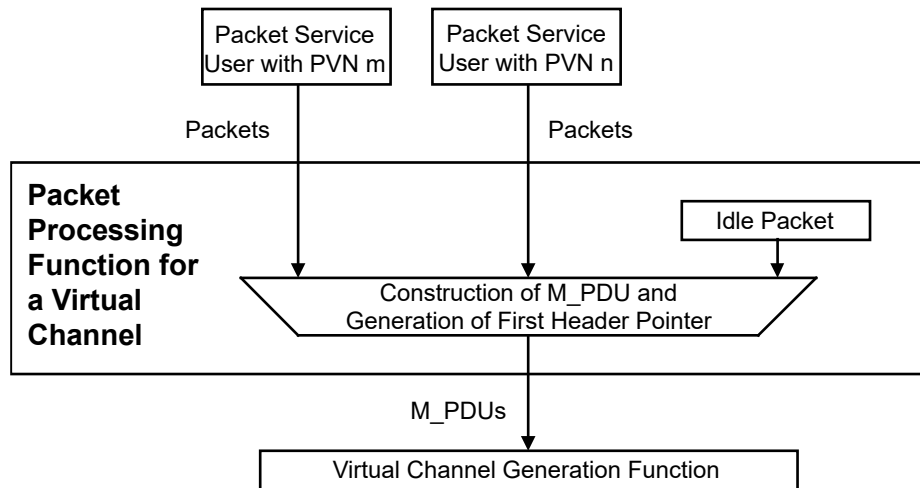


Figure 4-8: Abstract Model of Packet Processing Function

4.2.3 BITSTREAM PROCESSING FUNCTION

4.2.3.1 The Bitstream Processing Function shall be used to transfer variable-length streams of bits in the fixed-length B_PDU of Transfer Frames.

NOTE — There is an instance of the Bitstream Processing Function for each VC that carries Bitstream Data.

4.2.3.2 The Bitstream Processing Function shall be used to fill the Bitstream Data Zone of the B_PDU with the Bitstream Data supplied by the user. Each bit shall be placed sequentially into the B_PDU Bitstream Data Zone and shall be unchanged. When the Bitstream Data have filled one particular B_PDU, the continuation of the Bitstream Data shall be placed in a new B_PDU on the same VC.

NOTE — If, because of the constraints of the Transfer Frame release algorithm, a B_PDU is not completely filled by Bitstream Data at release time, the Bitstream Processing Function will fill the remainder of the B_PDU with a locally specified idle pattern. The boundary between the end of the valid Bitstream Data and the beginning of the idle data is indicated by setting a Bitstream Data Pointer in the B_PDU Header. If it is necessary, the Bitstream Processing Function may generate an ‘idle’ B_PDU by setting the Bitstream Data Pointer to ‘all ones minus one’.

4.2.3.3 The length of the B_PDU must be equal to the length of the Transfer Frame Data Field for the VC identified by the GVCID.

NOTE — An abstract model of the Bitstream Processing Function is illustrated in figure 4-9.

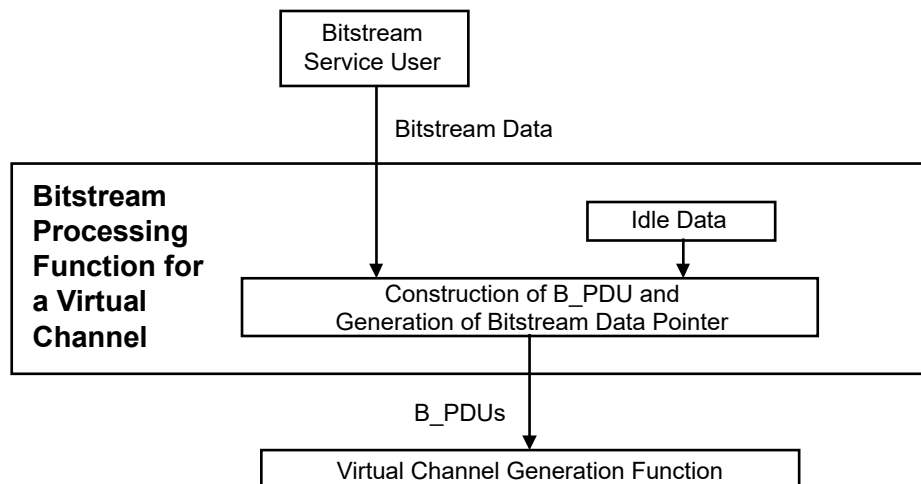


Figure 4-9: Abstract Model of Bitstream Processing Function

4.2.4 VIRTUAL CHANNEL GENERATION FUNCTION

The VC Generation Function is used to build the basic structure of Transfer Frames. It is also used to build the structure and the Primary Header of the Transfer Frames for transmission on each VC. There is an instance of the VC Generation Function for each VC.

4.2.4.1 Transfer Frames shall be assembled by placing a single unchanged M_PDU, B_PDU or VCA_SDU into the Transfer Frame Data Field and generating the Transfer Frame Primary Header fields. A Virtual Channel Frame Count shall be generated independently for each VC and placed into the Primary Header.

4.2.4.2 If there is a user of the VC_OCF Service for a particular VC, then an OCF_SDU supplied by the user shall be placed in the OCF.

4.2.4.3 The Insert Zone and the Frame Error Control Field of Transfer Frames, if present for a particular Physical Channel, shall be kept empty by the VC Generation Function.

NOTE – An abstract model of the VC Generation Function is illustrated in figure 4-10.

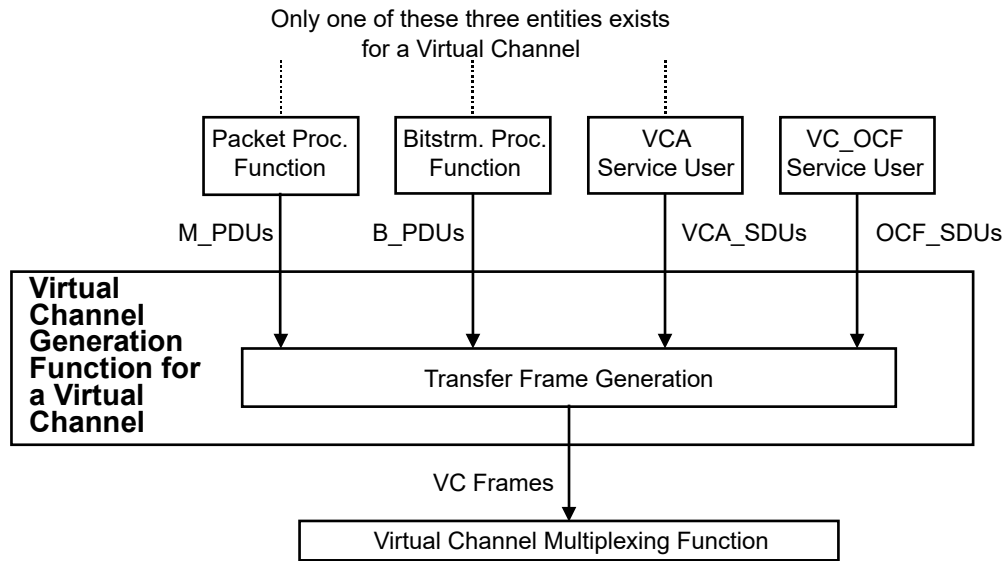


Figure 4-10: Abstract Model of Virtual Channel Generation Function

4.2.5 VIRTUAL CHANNEL MULTIPLEXING FUNCTION

4.2.5.1 The VC Multiplexing Function shall be used to multiplex Transfer Frames of different VCs of an MC.

NOTE – There is an instance of the VC Multiplexing Function for each MC that has multiple VCs.

4.2.5.2 The VC Multiplexing Function shall multiplex Transfer Frames received from the instances of the VC Generation Function and, if present, the VCF Service users, in an appropriate order that is set by management.

NOTE – The VC Multiplexing Function may put the multiplexed Transfer Frames into a queue.

4.2.5.3 The algorithm used to order the Transfer Frames is not specified by CCSDS, but shall be defined by project organizations considering factors such as priority, release rate, isochronous timing requirements, etc.

4.2.5.4 If there is only one MC on the Physical Channel, then the VC Multiplexing Function shall create an OID Transfer Frame to preserve the continuity of the transmitted stream in the event that there are no valid Transfer Frames available for transmission at a release time.

4.2.5.5 The OID Transfer Frame shall have its VCID set to the reserved value of ‘all ones’. It is not required to maintain a Virtual Channel Frame Count for OID Transfer Frames.

NOTE – An abstract model of the VC Multiplexing Function is illustrated in figure 4-11.

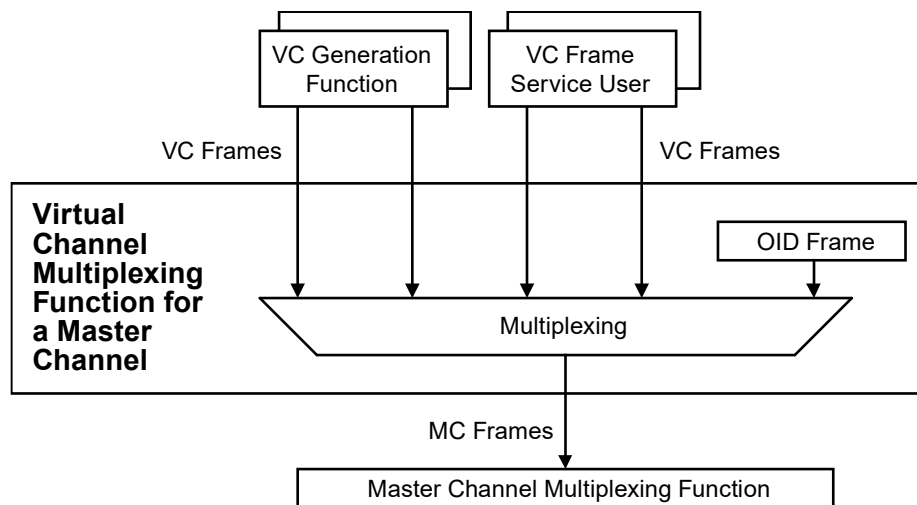


Figure 4-11: Abstract Model of Virtual Channel Multiplexing Function

4.2.6 MASTER CHANNEL MULTIPLEXING FUNCTION

4.2.6.1 The MC Multiplexing Function shall be used to multiplex Transfer Frames of different MCs of a Physical Channel.

NOTE — There is an instance of the MC Multiplexing Function for each Physical Channel that has multiple MCs.

4.2.6.2 The MC Multiplexing Function shall multiplex Transfer Frames received from the instances of the VC Multiplexing Function and, if present, the MCF Service users, in an appropriate order that is set by management.

NOTE — The MC Multiplexing Function may put the multiplexed Transfer Frames into a queue.

4.2.6.3 The algorithm to be used to order the Transfer Frames is not specified by CCSDS, but shall be defined by project organizations considering factors such as priority, release rate, isochronous timing requirements, etc.

4.2.6.4 The MC Multiplexing Function shall create an OID Transfer Frame to preserve the continuity of the transmitted stream in the event that there are no valid Transfer Frames available for transmission at a release time. The OID Transfer Frame shall have its VCID set to the reserved value of ‘all ones’ and its MCID set to one of the allowable values. It is not required to maintain a Virtual Channel Frame Count for OID Transfer Frames.

NOTE — An abstract model of the MC Multiplexing Function is illustrated in figure 4-12.

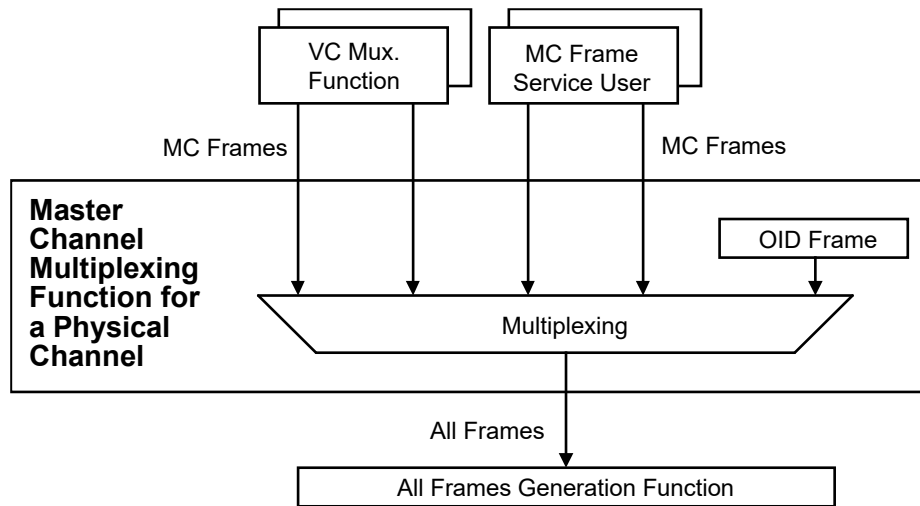


Figure 4-12: Abstract Model of Master Channel Multiplexing Function

4.2.7 ALL FRAMES GENERATION FUNCTION

4.2.7.1 The All Frames Generation Function shall be used to insert IN_SDUs into Transfer Frames of a Physical Channel. It shall also be used to perform error control encoding defined by this Recommended Standard.

NOTE – There is an instance of the All Frames Generation Function for each Physical Channel.

4.2.7.2 If the optional Insert Service is activated, a fixed-length Insert Zone shall exist in every Transfer Frame that is transmitted in a particular Physical Channel. The IN_SDUs shall be timed to arrive at a constant interval that corresponds to the release time of the Transfer Frames onto the Physical Channel. The All Frames Generation Function shall place the IN_SDUs, received from the Insert Service user, into the Insert Zone of the Transfer Frames, preserving octet alignment.

NOTE – This is possible because the Insert service cannot exist on a Physical Channel when either the VCF or MCF Service exists (see 3.2.6).

4.2.7.3 If the Frame Header Error Control is present, check bits shall be generated using the encoding procedure described in 4.1.2.5.3 and added to the Transfer Frame Primary Header. If this field is present, it must be present in all the Transfer Frames transmitted in a particular Physical Channel.

4.2.7.4 If the Frame Error Control Field is present, check bits shall be generated using the encoding procedure described in 4.1.6.2 and inserted into the Transfer Frame Trailer. If this field is present, it must be present in all the Transfer Frames transmitted in a particular Physical Channel.

4.2.7.5 Externally generated Transfer Frames associated with the VCF and MCF Services shall always bypass the error control encoding functions specified above. The users of these Services must therefore ensure that the Transfer Frames contain an error control option that conforms with options used by the service provider for the same Physical Channel.

NOTE – An abstract model of the All Frames Generation Function is illustrated in figure 4-13.

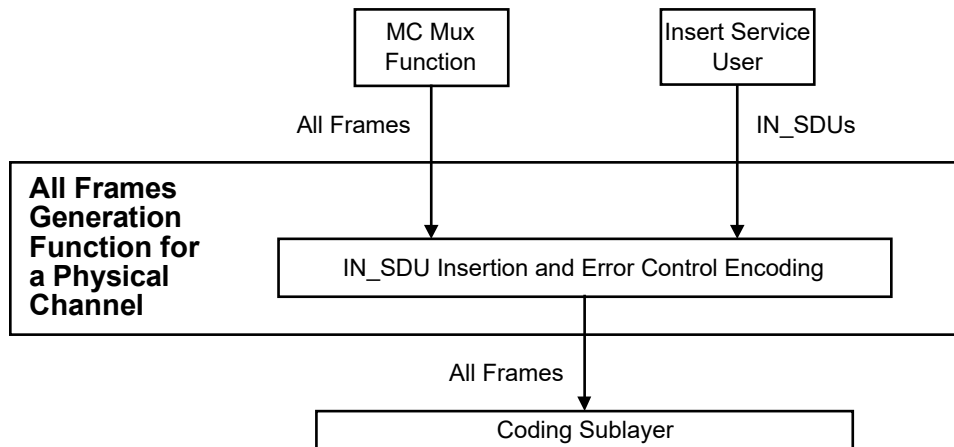


Figure 4-13: Abstract Model of All Frames Generation Function

4.3 PROTOCOL PROCEDURES AT RECEIVING END

4.3.1 OVERVIEW

This subsection describes procedures at the receiving end associated with each of the functions shown in figure 4-14. In this figure, data flow from bottom to top of the figure. This figure identifies data-handling functions performed by the protocol entity at the receiving end and shows logical relationships among these functions. This figure is not intended to imply any hardware or software configuration in a real system. Depending on the services actually used for a real system, not all of the functions may be present in the protocol entity. The procedures described in this subsection are defined in an abstract sense and are not intended to imply any particular implementation approach of a protocol entity.

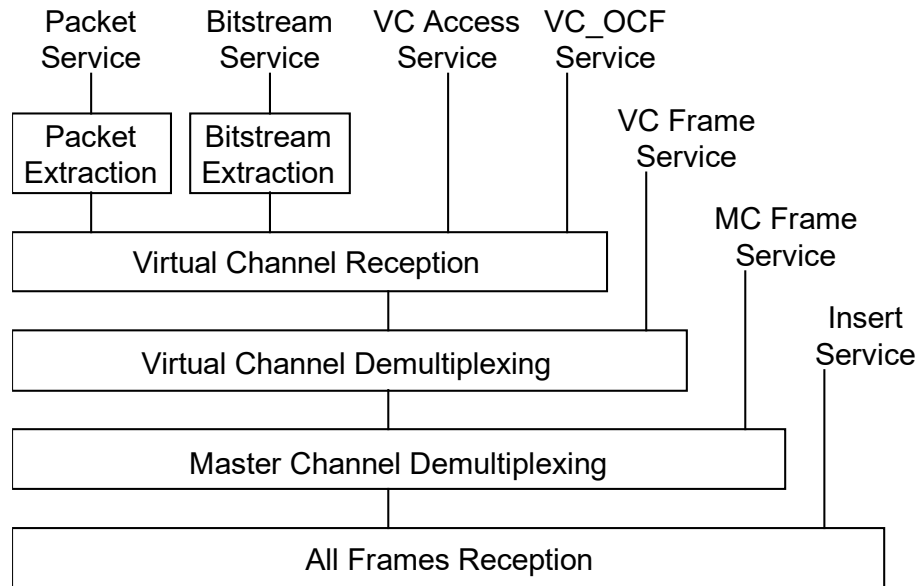


Figure 4-14: Internal Organization of Protocol Entity (Receiving End)

4.3.2 PACKET EXTRACTION FUNCTION

4.3.2.1 The Packet Extraction Function is used to extract variable-length Packets from the fixed-length M_PDUs.

NOTE – There is an instance of the Packet Extraction Function for each VC that carries Packets.

4.3.2.2 The Packet Extraction Function shall extract Packets from M_PDUs received from the VC Reception Function. The First Header Pointer of each M_PDU shall be used in conjunction with the length field of each Packet contained within the M_PDU to provide the delimiting information needed to extract Packets.

4.3.2.3 If the last Packet removed from the M_PDU is incomplete, the Packet Extraction Function shall retrieve its remainder from the beginning of the next M_PDU received on the same VC. The First Header Pointer for the next M_PDU shall be used to determine the length of the remainder and, hence, the beginning of the next Packet to be extracted.

4.3.2.4 If the calculated location of the beginning of the first Packet is not consistent with the location indicated by the First Header Pointer, the Packet Extraction Function shall assume that the First Header Pointer is correct, and shall continue the extraction based on that assumption.

4.3.2.5 Extracted Packets shall be delivered to the users on the basis of the Packet Version Number in their header.

NOTES

- 1 Incomplete Packets are not required to be delivered in cross support situations. Idle Packets are discarded. M_PDUs that contain only Idle Data are also discarded.
- 2 An abstract model of the Packet Extraction Function is illustrated in figure 4-15.

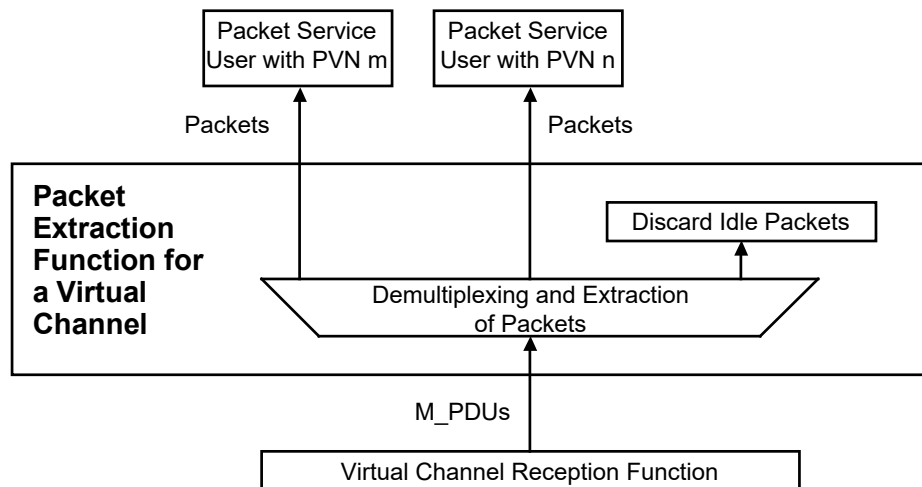


Figure 4-15: Abstract Model of Packet Extraction Function

4.3.3 BITSTREAM EXTRACTION FUNCTION

4.3.3.1 The Bitstream Extraction Function shall be used to extract variable-length Bitstream Data from fixed-length B_PDUs.

NOTE – There is an instance of the Bitstream Extraction Function for each VC that carries Bitstream Data.

4.3.3.2 The Bitstream Extraction Function shall be used to extract Bitstream Data from B_PDUs received from the VC Reception Function. The extracted Bitstream Data shall be delivered to the Bitstream service user identified by the GVCID. Any idle data inserted by the sending end shall be removed and discarded prior to delivery, using the Bitstream Data Pointer information.

4.3.3.3 The Bitstream Extraction Function may optionally pass a Bitstream Data Loss Flag to the user of the Bitstream Service as a parameter; the flag is derived from the Loss Flag received from the VC Reception Function.

NOTE – If used, the Bitstream Data Loss Flag indicates to the user that an indeterminate amount of Bitstream Data may have been lost. It should be noted that, if the Bitstream Data Loss Flag is set, and (one or more) subsequent B_PDUs are discarded because they contain only idle data, then the Flag must remain set until the next valid Bitstream Data is delivered to the user.

NOTE — An abstract model of the Bitstream Extraction Function is illustrated in figure 4-16.

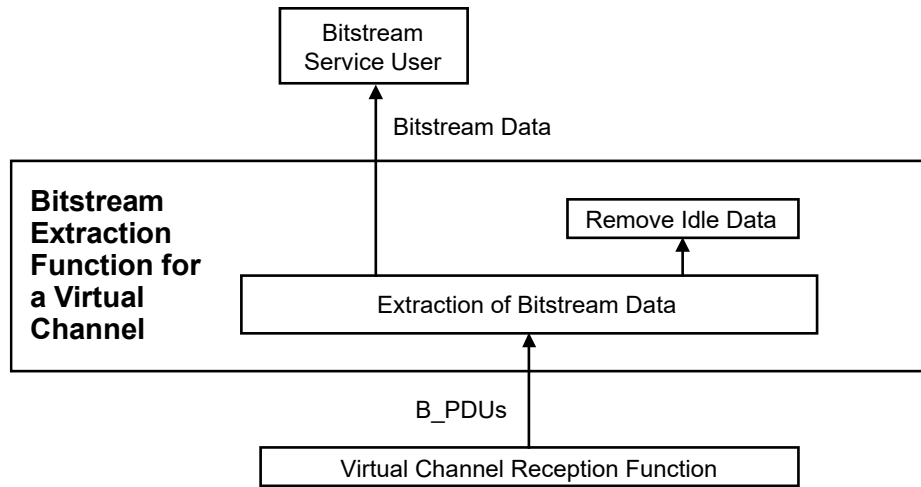


Figure 4-16: Abstract Model of Bitstream Reception Function

4.3.4 VIRTUAL CHANNEL RECEPTION FUNCTION

4.3.4.1 The VC Reception Function shall be used to decommutate fields of Transfer Frames of a VC.

NOTE — There is an instance of the VC Reception Function for each VC.

4.3.4.2 The VC Reception Function shall extract data units contained in the Data Field of the Transfer Frames, and deliver them to the user (i.e., the Packet Extraction Function, the Bitstream Extraction Function, or the VCA Service user).

4.3.4.3 If there is a user of the VC_OCF Service for a particular VC, OCF_SDUs contained in the OCF of the Transfer Frames shall be extracted and delivered to the user.

4.3.4.4 If a gap in the VC Frame Count is detected, a Loss Flag may (optionally) be delivered to the users.

NOTE — An abstract model of the VC Reception Function is illustrated in figure 4-17.

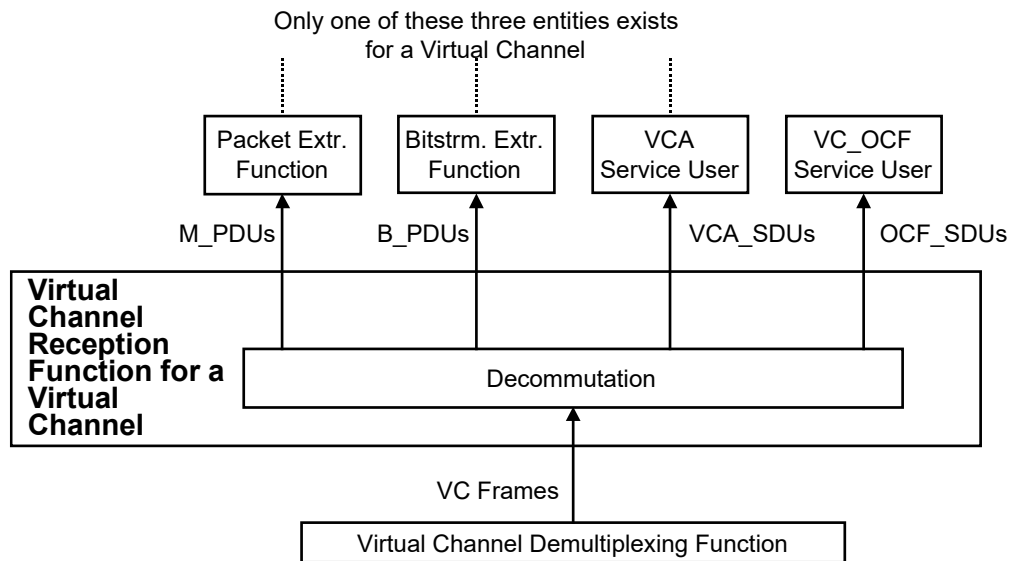


Figure 4-17: Abstract Model of Virtual Channel Reception Function

4.3.5 VIRTUAL CHANNEL DEMULTIPLEXING FUNCTION

4.3.5.1 The VC Demultiplexing Function shall be used to demultiplex Transfer Frames of different VCs of an MC.

NOTE – There is an instance of the VC Demultiplexing Function for each MC that has multiple VCs.

4.3.5.2 The VC Demultiplexing Function shall examine the VCID in the incoming stream of Transfer Frames and route them to the instances of the VC Reception Function and, if present, to the VCF Service users.

4.3.5.3 If a gap in the Virtual Channel Frame Count is detected, a Loss Flag may (optionally) be delivered to the users.

4.3.5.4 Transfer Frames with an invalid VCID shall be discarded.

NOTES

- 1 OID Transfer Frames are discarded.
- 2 Transfer Frames with an invalid VCID are frames with an ID not listed in table 5-2.
- 3 An abstract model of the VC Demultiplexing Function is illustrated in figure 4-18.

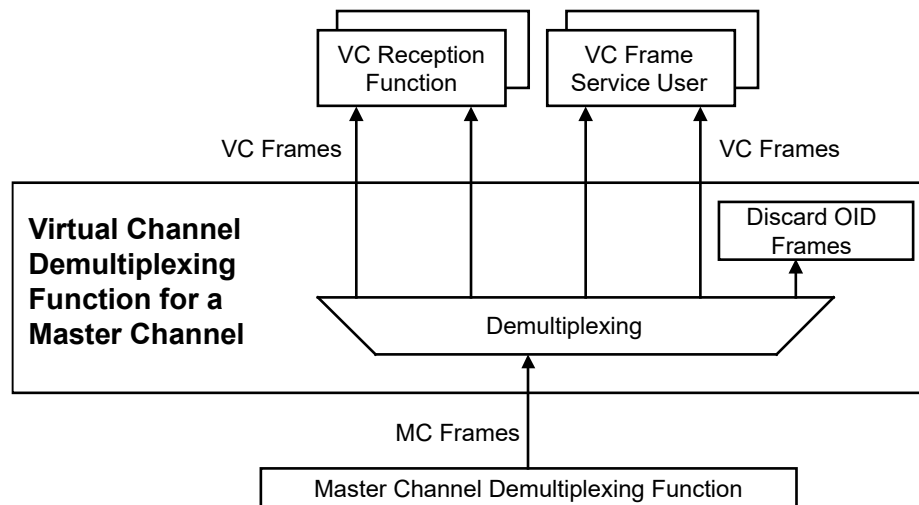


Figure 4-18: Abstract Model of Virtual Channel Demultiplexing Function

4.3.6 MASTER CHANNEL DEMULTIPLEXING FUNCTION

4.3.6.1 The MC Demultiplexing Function shall be used to demultiplex Transfer Frames of different MCs of a Physical Channel.

NOTE — There is an instance of the MC Demultiplexing Function for each Physical Channel that has multiple MCs.

4.3.6.2 The MC Demultiplexing Function shall examine the MCID in the incoming stream of Transfer Frames and route them to the instances of the VC Demultiplexing Function and, if present, to the MCF Service users.

4.3.6.3 Transfer Frames with an invalid MCID shall be discarded.

4.3.6.4 If frame loss is signaled by the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer, a Loss Flag may (optionally) be delivered to the users.

NOTES

- 1 Transfer Frames with an invalid MCID are frames with a SCID or a TFDVN not listed in table 5-1.
- 2 When more than one MC is used, the signal given by the underlying Channel Coding Sublayer (through the All Frames Reception Function) cannot identify on which MC frames have been lost; therefore the Loss Flag may be delivered to all users.
- 3 An abstract model of the MC Demultiplexing Function is illustrated in figure 4-19.

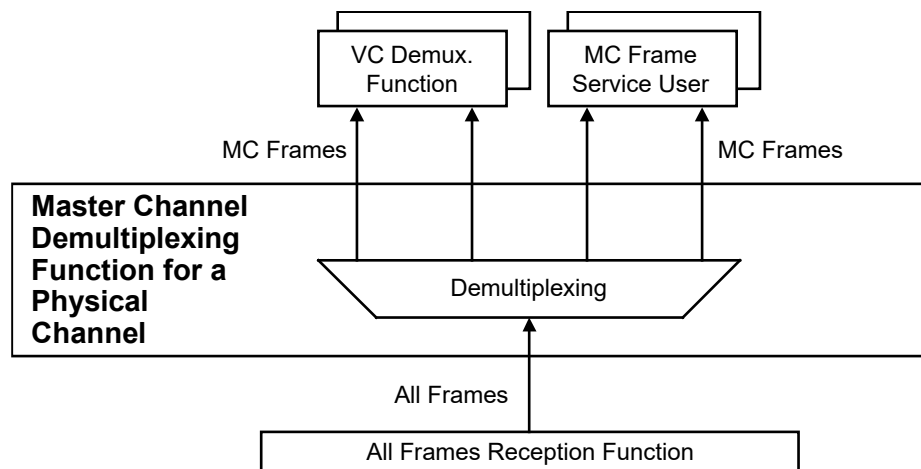


Figure 4-19: Abstract Model of Master Channel Demultiplexing Function

4.3.7 ALL FRAMES RECEPTION FUNCTION

4.3.7.1 The All Frames Reception Function shall be used to extract IN_SDU from Transfer Frames of a Physical Channel. It shall also be used to perform error control decoding defined by this Recommended Standard.

NOTE – There is an instance of the All Frames Reception Function for each Physical Channel.

4.3.7.2 If the Frame Header Error Control field is present in the Transfer Frame, then the All Frames Reception Function shall use the content of the Frame Header Error Control field to attempt to correct key elements of the Transfer Frame Primary Header.

NOTE – A Transfer Frame which contains detected and uncorrectable header errors is not required to be delivered in cross-support situations.

4.3.7.3 If the Frame Error Control Field is present in the Transfer Frame, the All Frames Reception Function shall recompute the CRC value for the Transfer Frame and compare it to the content of the Frame Error Control field to determine if the Transfer Frame contains a detected error.

NOTE – A Transfer Frame which contains a detected error is not required to be delivered in cross-support situations.

4.3.7.4 If the optional Insert Service is activated, the All Frames Reception Function shall extract the IN_SDUs from the Insert Zone of the incoming stream of Transfer Frames, regardless of their GVCID, and deliver them to the Insert Service user. If error protection of the IN_SDUs is not required, this function may be performed prior to decoding of Frame Error Control Field described above.

NOTE – An abstract model of the All Frames Reception Function is illustrated in figure 4-20.

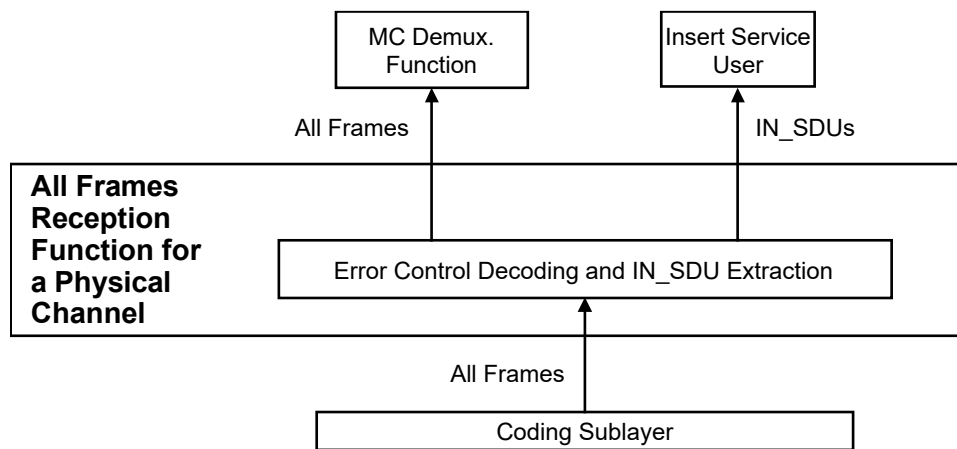


Figure 4-20: Abstract Model of All Frames Reception Function

5 MANAGED PARAMETERS WITHOUT SDLS OPTION

5.1 OVERVIEW OF MANAGED PARAMETERS

In order to conserve bandwidth on the space link, some parameters associated with the AOS Space Data Link Protocol are handled by management rather than by inline communications protocol. The managed parameters are those that tend to remain static for long periods of time, and whose change generally signifies a major reconfiguration of the protocol entities associated with a particular mission. Through the use of a management system, management conveys the required information to the protocol entities.

This section contains the managed parameters used by the AOS Space Data Link Protocol for Packet transfer and each type of Channel. These parameters are defined in an abstract sense and are not intended to imply any particular implementation of a management system.

NOTE – This section specifies managed parameters for the AOS Space Data Link Protocol without support for the SDLS protocol. Additional managed parameters for the AOS Space Data Link Protocol with the SDLS option are specified in 6.6.

5.2 MANAGED PARAMETERS FOR A PHYSICAL CHANNEL

Table 5-1 lists the managed parameters associated with a Physical Channel.

Table 5-1: Managed Parameters for a Physical Channel

Managed Parameter	Allowed Values
Physical Channel Name	Character String
Transfer Frame Length (octets)	Integer
Transfer Frame Version Number	2
Valid Spacecraft IDs	Set of Integers
MC Multiplexing Scheme	Mission Specific
Presence of Frame Header Error Control	Present, Absent
Presence of Insert Zone	Present, Absent
Insert Zone Length (octets)	Integer
Presence of Frame Error Control	Present, Absent

5.3 MANAGED PARAMETERS FOR A MASTER CHANNEL

Table 5-2 lists the managed parameters associated with an MC.

Table 5-2: Managed Parameters for a Master Channel

Managed Parameter	Allowed Values
Spacecraft ID	Integer
Valid VCIDs	Selectable Set of Integers (from 0 to 62) (in addition to VCID 63)
VC Multiplexing Scheme	Mission Specific
NOTES	
1	The value of the Transfer Frame Version Number is the same for all Transfer Frames on a Physical Channel.
2	For VCID the binary value of 'all ones' (i.e., 63) is always valid as it is reserved for OID Transfer Frames by 4.1.4.1.5; i.e., the number of Valid VCIDs always includes value 63 and the Selectable Set of Integers defined above.

5.4 MANAGED PARAMETERS FOR A VIRTUAL CHANNEL

Table 5-3 lists the managed parameters associated with a VC.

Table 5-3: Managed Parameters for a Virtual Channel

Managed Parameter	Allowed Values
Spacecraft ID	Integer
VCID	0, 1, ..., 62 (63 reserved)
Data Field Content	M_PDU, B_PDU, VCA_SDU, Idle Data
Presence of VC_OCF	Present, Absent
NOTES	
1	The value of the Transfer Frame Version Number is the same for all Transfer Frames on a Physical Channel.
2	VCID value 63 (i.e., the binary 'all ones') is reserved for OID Transfer Frames by 4.1.4.1.5.

5.5 MANAGED PARAMETERS FOR PACKET TRANSFER

Table 5-4 lists the managed parameters associated with a VC used for the VCP Service.

Table 5-4: Managed Parameters for Packet Transfer

Managed Parameter	Allowed Values
Valid Packet Version Numbers	Set of Integers
Maximum Packet Length (octets)	Integer
Whether incomplete Packets are required to be delivered to the user at the receiving end	Required, Not required

6 PROTOCOL SPECIFICATION WITH SPACE DATA LINK SECURITY OPTION

6.1 OVERVIEW

This section specifies the protocol data unit and the procedures of the AOS Space Data Link Protocol with support for the Space Data Link Security Protocol (reference [10]). If the AOS Space Data Link protocol entity supports SDLS, it has managed parameters for each VC to indicate whether SDLS is in use for that channel (see 6.6). Section 4 contains the specification of the protocol without the SDLS option.

6.2 USE OF SDLS PROTOCOL

If SDLS as defined in reference [10] is required over the AOS space data link, then the SDLS protocol shall be used.

NOTE – The SDLS protocol provides a security header and trailer along with associated procedures that may be used with the AOS Space Data Link Protocol to provide data authentication and confidentiality at the Data Link Layer.

6.3 AOS TRANSFER FRAME WITH SDLS

6.3.1 OVERVIEW

To support the use of the SDLS security features, a Security Header and a Security Trailer are defined for an AOS Transfer Frame. The use of SDLS can vary between VCs, so a managed parameter indicates the presence of the Security Header (see 6.6). If the Security Header is present, then SDLS is in use for the VC. This subsection specifies the AOS Transfer Frames on a VC that is using SDLS.

If a VC is not using SDLS, then the frames are as specified in 4.1.

The Security Header and Security Trailer are placed before and after the Transfer Frame Data Field, reducing its length compared to a frame without SDLS. Figure 6-1 compares the frame fields for a frame with and without SDLS. The upper part of figure 6-1 shows the AOS Transfer Frame without the SDLS fields and is the same as figure 4-1.

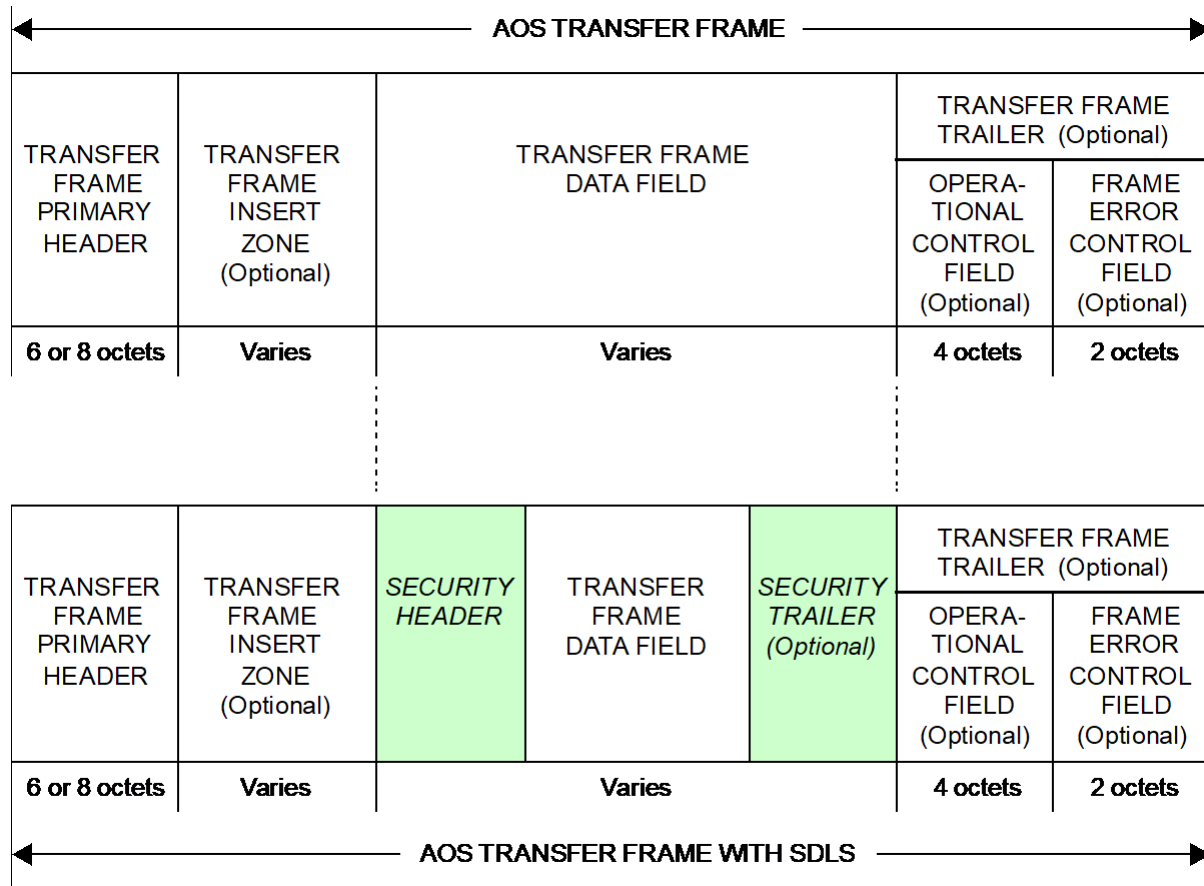


Figure 6-1: Frame without SDLS Compared to Frame with SDLS

6.3.2 TRANSFER FRAME PRIMARY HEADER IN A FRAME WITH SDLS

The Transfer Frame Primary Header for a frame with SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.1.2.

NOTES

- 1 The Transfer Frame Primary Header is the same for a frame with or without SDLS.
- 2 The Transfer Frame Primary Header includes the Replay Flag (see 4.1.2.5.2). An exact interpretation of this flag is the subject of negotiation between projects and cross-support organizations; the handling of frames with this flag set to '1' (meaning Replay Transfer Frames) is mission-specific. The application of SDLS procedures to these frames is also mission-specific.

6.3.3 TRANSFER FRAME INSERT ZONE IN A FRAME WITH SDLS

The Transfer Frame Insert Zone shall conform to the specifications of 4.1.3.

NOTE – The Transfer Frame Insert Zone is the same for a frame with or without SDLS.

6.3.4 SECURITY HEADER

If present, the Security Header shall follow, without gap, the Transfer Frame Insert Zone (if it is present), or the Transfer Frame Primary Header (if a Transfer Frame Insert Zone is absent).

NOTES

- 1 The presence of the Security Header is a managed parameter of the VC (see 6.6). If the Security Header is not present, the Transfer Frame has the format specified in 4.1.
- 2 The requirements for the length and contents of the Security Header are specified in reference [10].
- 3 The length of the Security Header is an integral number of octets and a managed parameter of the VC.

6.3.5 TRANSFER FRAME DATA FIELD IN A FRAME WITH SDLS

6.3.5.1 The Transfer Frame Data Field of a frame with SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.1.4.1.3 through 4.1.4.1.5 as modified by 6.3.5.2.

6.3.5.2 In a Transfer Frame with SDLS, the Transfer Frame Data Field shall

- a) follow, without gap, the Security Header;

NOTE – Therefore, in this case, the data unit that is placed into the Transfer Frame Data Field follows, without gap, the Security Header. The data unit can be an M_PDU, a B_PDU or a VCA_SDU (see 4.1.4.1.3).

- b) contain an integer number of octets equal to the fixed Transfer Frame length selected for use on a particular Physical Channel, minus
 - the lengths of the Transfer Frame Primary Header and of the Security Header;
 - the lengths of the Transfer Frame Insert Zone, of the Security Trailer and of the Transfer Frame Trailer, if any of these are present.

6.3.6 SECURITY TRAILER

If present, the Security Trailer shall follow, without gap, the Transfer Frame Data Field.

NOTES

- 1 The Security Trailer is optional in an AOS Transfer Frame with SDLS. The presence of the Security Trailer is a managed parameter of the VC (see 6.6).
- 2 The requirements for the length and contents of the Security Trailer are specified in reference [10].
- 3 The length of the Security Trailer is an integral number of octets and a managed parameter of the VC.

6.3.7 OPERATIONAL CONTROL FIELD IN A FRAME WITH SDLS

6.3.7.1 The OCF of a frame with SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.1.5.2 through 4.1.5.5 as modified by 6.3.7.2.

6.3.7.2 In a Transfer Frame with SDLS, the OCF, if present, shall occupy the four octets following, without gap, the Security Trailer (if it is present), or the Transfer Frame Data Field (if a Security Trailer is absent).

6.3.8 FRAME ERROR CONTROL FIELD IN A FRAME WITH SDLS

6.3.8.1 The Frame Error Control Field of a frame with SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.1.6.1.2, 4.1.6.1.3, 4.1.6.2, 4.1.6.3, as modified by 6.3.8.2.

6.3.8.2 In a Transfer Frame with SDLS, the Frame Error Control Field, if present, shall occupy the two octets following, without gap:

- the OCF if it is present;
- the Security Trailer if it is present and the OCF is not;
- the Transfer Frame Data Field if neither the OCF nor the Security Trailer are present.

6.4 SENDING END PROTOCOL PROCEDURES WITH SDLS**6.4.1 OVERVIEW**

When a secure AOS link is required, the AOS Space Data Link Protocol supports the use of the SDLS protocol. In this case, the AOS Space Data Link Protocol contains differences in the sending end procedures compared to the procedures described in 4.2. This subsection defines those differences.

The SDLS ApplySecurity Function may interface with the AOS Space Data Link Protocol at either the VC Generation Function (4.2.4) or the VC Multiplexing Function (4.2.5). The choice of where to apply security within the AOS Data Link Layer depends upon several factors such

as the number of Security Associations (SAs), their type (one VC or more than one VC per SA), and the corresponding source and termination of the security function(s), key management, and the use of the anti-replay feature.

For example, there can be security configurations in which one or several SAs covering just one VC each are present. The physical location of the security processing may not be the same for all VCs, at the sending end or at the receiving end. This case can be supported by placing the SDLS interface in the VC Generation Function where the greatest flexibility in managing the security function occurs.

Conversely, with the SDLS interface in the VC Multiplexing Function, the security configuration can include multiple VCs (not necessarily all) sharing an SDLS Security Association. The call to the SDLS ApplySecurity function follows the VC multiplexing, so that the SDLS processing is applied to the multiplexed stream of frames.

6.4.2 PACKET PROCESSING FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.4.2.1 The Packet Processing Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.2.2 and 6.4.2.2.

6.4.2.2 When handling Packets on a VC that uses SDLS, the Packet Processing Function shall apply the Transfer Frame Data Field specification in 6.3.5 to determine the length of the M_PDUs that it generates.

NOTE – The Packet Processing Function generates fixed-length M_PDUs to fit exactly within the fixed-length Transfer Frame Data Field (see 4.1.4.2.1.2).

6.4.3 BITSTREAM PROCESSING FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.4.3.1 The Bitstream Processing Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.2.3 and 6.4.3.2.

6.4.3.2 When handling Bitstream Data on a VC that uses SDLS, the Bitstream Processing Function shall apply the Transfer Frame Data Field specification in 6.3.5 to determine the length of the B_PDUs that it generates.

NOTE – The Bitstream Processing Function generates fixed-length B_PDUs to fit exactly within the fixed-length Transfer Frame Data Field (see 4.1.4.3.1.2).

6.4.4 VIRTUAL CHANNEL GENERATION FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.4.4.1 When assembling a Transfer Frame, the VC Generation Function shall conform to the specifications of 4.2.4, 6.3, and 6.4.4.2 through 6.4.4.3.

6.4.4.2 The Security Header and the Security Trailer, if it is present for the VC, shall be kept empty.

NOTES

- 1 The SDLS ApplySecurity Function specified in reference [10] provides the contents of these security fields as necessary and may modify the contents of the Transfer Frame Data Field by encrypting the data.
- 2 The lengths of the Security Header and Security Trailer are managed parameters of the VC (see 6.6).

6.4.4.3 If the VC Generation Function contains the interface to the SDLS protocol,

- it shall call the SDLS ApplySecurity function for the Transfer Frames that it assembles for VCs that use SDLS;
- the order of processing between the functions of the AOS and SDLS protocols shall occur as follows in the VC Generation Function:
 - 1) the frame assembly processing by the VC Generation Function;
 - 2) the call by the VC Generation Function to the SDLS ApplySecurity Function.

NOTE – The way in which Transfer Frame data is passed between the VC Generation Function and the SDLS ApplySecurity Function is implementation dependent.

6.4.5 VIRTUAL CHANNEL MULTIPLEXING FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.4.5.1 The VC Multiplexing Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.2.5, 6.4.5.2.

6.4.5.2 If the VC Multiplexing Function contains the interface to the SDLS protocol,

- it shall call the SDLS ApplySecurity function for Transfer Frames on VCs that use SDLS after the frames have been selected by the multiplexing algorithm;
- the order of processing between the functions of the AOS and SDLS protocols shall occur as follows in the VC Multiplexing Function:
 - 1) the VC multiplexing processing of the VC Multiplexing Function;
 - 2) the call by the VC Multiplexing Function to the SDLS ApplySecurity Function.

6.4.6 MASTER CHANNEL MULTIPLEXING FUNCTION WITH SDLS

The MC Multiplexing Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.2.6.

6.4.7 ALL FRAMES GENERATION FUNCTION WITH SDLS

The All Frames Generation Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.2.7.

NOTE – There is no interface between the SDLS ApplySecurity function with the AOS ‘All Frames Generation’ function in order to guarantee that the Frame Error Control field is computed after the SDLS function has processed the frame.

6.5 RECEIVING END PROTOCOL PROCEDURES WITH SDLS

6.5.1 OVERVIEW

When the AOS Transfer Frame Protocol supports the use of the SDLS protocol, there are differences in the receiving end procedures compared to the procedures described in 4.3. This subsection defines those differences.

The position of the SDLS interface is generally selected to reflect the position of the corresponding interface at the sending end. These choices include the VC Demultiplexing Function or the VC Reception Function, corresponding to the options discussed in 6.4.1.

6.5.2 ERROR REPORTING

6.5.2.1 Discussion

Depending on the security features in use, the SDLS ProcessSecurity function specified in reference [10] can verify the authenticity of the frame and decrypt the contents of the Transfer Frame Data Field. If the SDLS ProcessSecurity Function detects any errors, they are reported to either the VC Demultiplexing Function or the VC Reception Function. The way that Transfer Frame data is passed between either of these Functions and the SDLS ProcessSecurity Function is implementation-dependent.

6.5.2.2 Requirements

6.5.2.2.1 If the SDLS ProcessSecurity Function does not report an error, the VC Reception Function shall extract the contents of the Transfer Frame Data Field from the frame and deliver it to its user (or Function).

6.5.2.2.2 If the SDLS ProcessSecurity Function reports an error, either the VC Demultiplexing Function or the VC Reception Function shall discard the frame (depending on the interface point).

NOTE – In this case, the optional Verification Status Code parameter can be used to inform the user of the relevant service (see 3.3.2.6, 3.4.2.5, and 3.5.2.5).

6.5.3 PACKET EXTRACTION FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.5.3.1 The Packet Extraction Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.3.2 and 6.5.3.2.

6.5.3.2 When handling Packets on a VC that uses SDLS, the Packet Extraction Function shall apply the Transfer Frame Data Field specification in 6.3.5 to determine the expected length of the M_PDUs that it receives.

NOTE – The Packet Extraction Function receives fixed-length M_PDUs that fit exactly within the fixed-length Transfer Frame Data Field (see 4.1.4.2.1.2).

6.5.4 BITSTREAM EXTRACTION FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.5.4.1 The Bitstream Extraction Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.3.3 and 6.5.4.2.

6.5.4.2 When handling Bitstream Data on a VC that uses SDLS, the Bitstream Extraction Function shall apply the Transfer Frame Data Field specification in 6.3.5 to determine the length of the B_PDUs that it receives.

NOTE – The Bitstream Extraction Function receives fixed-length B_PDUs that fit exactly within the fixed-length Transfer Frame Data Field (see 4.1.4.3.1.2).

6.5.5 VIRTUAL CHANNEL RECEPTION FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.5.5.1 The VC Reception Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.3.4 and 6.5.5.2 through 6.5.5.3.

6.5.5.2 If the VC Reception Function contains the interface to the SDLS protocol, it shall call the SDLS ProcessSecurity function for the Transfer Frames that it handles for VCs that use SDLS.

6.5.5.3 When handling a Transfer Frame on a VC that uses SDLS, the VC Reception Function shall apply the Transfer Frame specification in 6.3 to determine the lengths and positions of the fields in the Transfer Frame.

6.5.6 VIRTUAL CHANNEL DEMULTIPLEXING FUNCTION WITH SDLS

6.5.6.1 The VC Demultiplexing Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.3.5 and 6.5.6.2.

6.5.6.2 If the VC Demultiplexing Function contains the interface to the SDLS protocol, it shall call the SDLS ProcessSecurity function for Transfer Frames on VCs that use SDLS, before the demultiplexing is applied.

6.5.7 MASTER CHANNEL DEMULTIPLEXING FUNCTION WITH SDLS

The MC Demultiplexing Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.3.6.

6.5.8 ALL FRAMES RECEPTION FUNCTION WITH SDLS

The All Frames Reception Function of an AOS Protocol entity that supports SDLS shall conform to the specifications of 4.3.7.

6.6 MANAGED PARAMETERS WITH SDLS

6.6.1 OVERVIEW

Managed parameters for the SDLS protocol are specified in reference [10].

6.6.2 ADDITIONAL MANAGED PARAMETERS FOR A VIRTUAL CHANNEL

The managed parameters associated with a VC for the AOS Space Data Link Protocol that supports the SDLS protocol shall conform to the definitions in table 5-4 and the additional definitions in table 6-1.

Table 6-1: Additional Managed Parameters for a Virtual Channel when AOS Space Data Link Protocol Supports SDLS

Managed Parameter	Allowed Values
Presence of Space Data Link Security Header	Present / Absent
Presence of Space Data Link Security Trailer	Present / Absent
Length of Space Data Link Security Header (octets)	Integer
Length of Space Data Link Security Trailer (octets)	Integer
NOTES	
1	If the Security Header is present, then SDLS is in use for the VC.
2	The valid lengths for the Security Header and Security Trailer are specified in reference [10].

ANNEX A

PROTOCOL IMPLEMENTATION CONFORMANCE STATEMENT PROFORMA

(NORMATIVE)

A1 INTRODUCTION

A1.1 OVERVIEW

This annex provides the Protocol Implementation Conformance Statement (PICS) Requirements List (RL) for an implementation of the *AOS Space Data Link Protocol* (CCSDS 732.0-P-4.1). The PICS for an implementation is generated by completing the RL in accordance with the instructions below. An implementation claiming conformance must satisfy the mandatory requirements referenced in the RL.

The RL support column in this annex is blank. An implementation's completed RL is called the PICS. The PICS states which capabilities and options have been implemented. The following can use the PICS:

- the implementer, as a checklist to reduce the risk of failure to conform to the standard through oversight;
- a supplier or potential acquirer of the implementation, as a detailed indication of the capabilities of the implementation, stated relative to the common basis for understanding provided by the standard PICS proforma;
- a user or potential user of the implementation, as a basis for initially checking the possibility of interworking with another implementation (it should be noted that, while interworking can never be guaranteed, failure to interwork can often be predicted from incompatible PICSes);
- a tester, as the basis for selecting appropriate tests against which to assess the claim for conformance of the implementation.

A1.2 ABBREVIATIONS AND CONVENTIONS

The RL consists of information in tabular form. The status of features is indicated using the abbreviations and conventions described below.

Item Column

The item column contains sequential numbers for items in the table.

NOTE – The item-number prefix 'AOS' = 'Data Link Layer'.

Feature Column

The feature column contains a brief descriptive name for a feature. It implicitly means ‘Is this feature supported by the implementation?’

Status Column

The status column uses the following notations:

M	mandatory.
O	optional.
C#	Conditional; condition stated below table.
O.<n>	optional, but support of at least one of the group of options labeled by the same numeral <n> is required.
N/A	Not applicable.

Support Column Symbols

The support column is to be used by the implementer to state whether a feature is supported by entering Y, N, or N/A, indicating:

Y	Yes, supported by the implementation.
N	No, not supported by the implementation.
N/A	Not applicable.

The support column should also be used, when appropriate, to enter values supported for a given capability.

A1.3 INSTRUCTIONS FOR COMPLETING THE REQUIREMENTS LIST

An implementer shows the extent of compliance to the Recommended Standard by completing the RL; that is, the state of compliance with all mandatory requirements and the options supported are shown. The resulting completed RL is called a PICS. The implementer shall complete the RL by entering appropriate responses in the support or values supported column, using the notation described in A1.2. If a conditional requirement is inapplicable, N/A should be used. If a mandatory requirement is not satisfied, exception information must be supplied by entering a reference X_i , where i is a unique identifier, to an accompanying rationale for the noncompliance.

A2 PICS PROFORMA FOR AOS SPACE DATA LINK PROTOCOL (CCSDS 732.0-P-4.1)

A2.1 GENERAL INFORMATION

A2.1.1 Identification of PICS

Date of Statement (DD/MM/YYYY)	
PICS serial number	
System Conformance statement cross-reference	

A2.1.2 Identification of Implementation Under Test

Implementation name	
Implementation version	
Special Configuration	
Other Information	

A2.1.3 Identification of Supplier

Supplier	
Contact Point for Queries	
Implementation Name(s) and Versions	
Other information necessary for full identification, e.g., name(s) and version(s) for machines and/or operating systems;	
System Name(s)	

A2.1.4 Identification of Specification

CCSDS 732.0-P-4.1	
Have any exceptions been required? NOTE – A YES answer means that the implementation does not conform to the Recommended Standard. Non-supported mandatory capabilities are to be identified in the PICS, with an explanation of why the implementation is non-conforming.	Yes [] No []

A2.2 REQUIREMENTS LIST

Table A-1: AOS Service Data Units

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Support
AOS-1	Packet SDU	3.2.2	M	
AOS-2	Bitstream Data SDU	3.2.3	M	
AOS-3	VCA_SDU	3.2.4	M	
AOS-4	OCF_SDU	3.2.5	M	
AOS-5	AOS Transfer Frame	3.2.6	M	
AOS-6	Insert SDU	3.2.7	M	

Table A-2: Service Parameters

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Values Allowed	Support
VCP Packet Service Parameters					
AOS-7	Packet	3.3.2.2	M		
AOS-8	GVCID	3.3.2.3	M		
AOS-9	Packet Version Number	3.3.2.4	M		
AOS-10	Packet Quality Indicator	3.3.2.5	O		
AOS-11	Verification Status Code	3.3.2.6	C2	(see ref. [10])	
Bitstream SDU Service Parameters					
AOS-12	Bitstream Data	3.4.2.2	M		
AOS-13	GVCID	3.4.2.3	M		
AOS-14	Bitstream Data Loss Flag	3.4.2.4	O		
AOS-15	Verification Status Code	3.4.2.5	C2	(see ref. [10])	
VCA SDU Service Parameters					
AOS-16	VCA SDU	3.5.2.2	M		
AOS-17	GVCID	3.5.2.3	M		
AOS-18	VCA SDU Loss Flag	3.5.2.4	O		
AOS-19	Verification Status Code	3.5.2.5	C2	(see ref. [10])	
VC_OCF SDU Service Parameters					
AOS-20	OCF SDU	3.6.2.2	M		
AOS-21	GVCID	3.6.2.3	M		
AOS-22	OCF_SDU Loss Flag	3.6.2.4	O		
VCF Service Parameters					
AOS-23	AOS Frame	3.7.2.2	M		
AOS-24	GVCID	3.7.2.3	M		
AOS-25	Frame Loss Flag	3.7.2.4	O		
MCF Service Parameters					
AOS-26	AOS Frame	3.8.2.2	M		

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Values Allowed	Support
AOS-27	MCID	3.8.2.3	M		
AOS-28	Frame Loss Flag	3.8.2.4	O		
Insert Service Parameters					
AOS-29	IN_SDU	3.9.2.2	M		
AOS-30	Physical Channel Name	3.9.2.3	M		
AOS-31	IN_SDU Loss Flag	3.9.2.4	O		

C2: O if SDLS Option else N/A.

Table A-3: Service Primitives

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Support
VCP Service Primitives				
AOS-32	VCP.request	3.3.3.2	M	
AOS-33	VCP.indication	3.3.3.3	M	
Bitstream Service Primitives				
AOS-34	Bitstream.request	3.4.3.2	M	
AOS-35	Bitstream.indication	3.4.3.3	M	
VCA Service Primitives				
AOS-36	VCA.request	3.5.3.2	M	
AOS-37	VCA.indication	3.5.3.3	M	
VC_OCF Service Primitives				
AOS-38	VC_OCF.request	3.6.3.2	M	
AOS-39	VC_OCF.indication	3.6.3.3	M	
VCF Service Primitives				
AOS-40	VCF.request	3.7.3.2	M	
AOS-41	VCF.indication	3.7.3.3	M	
MCF Service Primitives				
AOS-42	MCF.request	3.8.3.2	M	
AOS-43	MCF.indication	3.8.3.3	M	
Insert Service Primitives				
AOS-44	INSERT.request	3.9.3.2	M	
AOS-45	INSERT.indication	3.9.3.3	M	

Table A-4: AOS Protocol Data Unit

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Support
AOS-46	AOS Transfer Frame	4.1.1	M	
AOS-47	Transfer Frame Primary Header	4.1.2	M	
AOS-47.1	SCID Length	4.1.2.2.3	M	
AOS-48	Transfer Frame Insert Zone	4.1.3	M	
AOS-49	Transfer Frame Data Field	4.1.4	M	
AOS-50	Operational Control Field	4.1.5	M	
AOS-51	Frame Error Control Field	4.1.6	M	

Table A-5: Protocol Procedures

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Support
AOS-52	Packet Processing Function	4.2.2	M	
AOS-53	Bitstream Processing Function	4.2.3	M	
AOS-54	VC Generation Function	4.2.4	M	
AOS-55	VC Multiplexing Function	4.2.5	M	
AOS-56	MC Multiplexing Function	4.2.6	M	
AOS-57	All Frames Generation Function	4.2.7	M	
AOS-58	Packet Extraction Function	4.3.2	M	
AOS-59	Bitstream Extraction Function	4.3.3	M	
AOS-60	VC Reception Function	4.3.4	M	
AOS-61	VC Demultiplexing Function	4.3.5	M	
AOS-62	MC Demultiplexing Function	4.3.6	M	
AOS-63	All Frames Reception Function	4.3.7	M	

Table A-6: Management Parameters

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Values Allowed	Support
Managed Parameters for a Physical Channel					
AOS-64	Physical Channel Name	Table 5-1	M	Character String	
AOS-65	Transfer Frame Length (octets)	Table 5-1	M	Integer	
AOS-66	TFVN	Table 5-1	M	'01' binary	
AOS-67	Valid Spacecraft IDs	Table 5-1	M	Integer	
AOS-68	MC Multiplexing Scheme	Table 5-1	M	Mission Specific	
AOS-69	Presence of Frame Header Error Control	Table 5-1	M	Present ('1') / Absent ('0')	
AOS-70	Presence of Insert Zone	Table 5-1	M	Present ('1') / Absent ('0')	
AOS-71	Insert Zone Length (octets)	Table 5-1	M	Integer	
AOS-72	Presence of Frame Error Control	Table 5-1	M	Present ('1') / Absent ('0')	
Managed Parameters for a Master Channel					
AOS-73	SCID	Table 5-2	M	Integer	
AOS-74	Valid VCIDs	Table 5-2	M	Selectable set of integers (from 0 to 62) In addition to VCID 63	
AOS-75	VC Multiplexing Scheme	Table 5-2	M	Mission Specific	
Managed Parameters for a Virtual Channel					
AOS-76	SCID	Table 5-3	M	Integer	
AOS-77	VCID	Table 5-3	M	0 to 62, 63 is reserved	
AOS-78	Data Field Content	Table 5-3	M	M_PDU, B_PDU, VCA_SDU, Idle Data	
AOS-79	Presence of VC_OCF	Table 5-3	M	Present ('1') / Absent ('0')	
Managed Parameters for Packet Transfer					
AOS-80	Valid PVNs	Table 5-4	M	Set of Integers	
AOS-81	Maximum Packet Length (octets)	Table 5-4	M	Integer	
AOS-82	Whether incomplete Packets are required to be delivered to the user at the receiving end	Table 5-4	M	Required, not required	

Table A-7: Protocol Specification with SDLS Option

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Support
AOS-83	SDLS Protocol	(see ref. [10])	O	
AOS-84	Security Header	6.3.4	C3	
AOS-85	Transfer Frame Data Field in a AOS Frame with SDLS	6.3.5	C3	
AOS-86	Security Trailer	6.3.6	C4	
AOS-87	Operational Control Field in a AOS Frame with SDLS	6.3.7.2	C3	
AOS-88	Frame Error Control Field in a AOS Frame with SDLS	6.3.8.2	C3	
AOS-89	Packet Processing Function with SDLS	6.4.2.2	C3	
AOS-90	Bitstream Processing Function with SDLS	6.4.3.2	C3	
AOS-91	Virtual Channel Generation Function with SDLS	6.4.4	C3	
AOS-92	Virtual Channel Multiplexing Function with SDLS	6.4.5	C3	
AOS-93	Error reporting	6.5.2.2	C4	
AOS-94	Packet Extraction Function with SDLS	6.5.3.2	C3	
AOS-95	Bitstream Extraction Function with SDLS	6.5.4.2	C3	
AOS-96	Virtual Channel Reception Function with SDLS	6.5.5	C3	
AOS-97	Virtual Channel Demultiplexing Function with SDLS	6.5.6	C3	

C3: M if SDLS Option else N/A.

C4: O if SDLS Option else N/A.

Table A-8: Additional Managed Parameters with SDLS Option

Item	Description	Reference	Status	Values Allowed	Support
AOS-98	Presence of Space Data Link Security Header	Table 6-1	C5	Present ('1') / Absent ('0')	
AOS-99	Presence of Space Data Link Security Trailer	Table 6-1	C5	Present ('1') / Absent ('0')	
AOS-100	Length of Space Data Link Security Header (octets)	Table 6-1	C5	Integer (see ref. [10])	
AOS-101	Length of Space Data Link Security Trailer (octets)	Table 6-1	C5	Integer (see ref. [10])	

C5: M if SDLS Option else N/A.

ANNEX B

ACRONYMS

(INFORMATIVE)

This annex lists the acronyms used in this Recommended Standard.

AOS	Advanced Orbiting System
B_PDU	Bitstream Protocol Data Unit
CCSDS	Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems
COP	Communications Operation Procedure
CRC	Cyclic Redundancy Check
GVCID	Global Virtual Channel Identifier
LFSR	Linear Feedback Shift Register
LSB	Least Significant Bit
MC	Master Channel
MCF	Master Channel Frame
MCID	Master Channel Identifier
MSB	Most Significant Bit
M_PDU	Multiplexing Protocol Data Unit
OCF	Operational Control Field
OID	Only Idle Data
OSI	Open Systems Interconnection
PICS	Protocol Implementation Conformance Statement
PVN	Packet Version Number
RL	Requirements List
SANA	Space Assigned Numbers Authority

SAP	Service Access Point
SCID	Spacecraft Identifier
SDU	Service Data Unit
SDLS	Space Data Link Security
TFVN	Transfer Frame Version Number
VC	Virtual Channel
VCA	Virtual Channel Access
VCA_SDU	Virtual Channel Access Service Data Unit
VCF	Virtual Channel Frame
VCID	Virtual Channel Identifier
VCP	Virtual Channel Packet

ANNEX C

INFORMATIVE REFERENCES

(INFORMATIVE)

- [C1] *Organization and Processes for the Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems*. Issue 4. CCSDS Record (Yellow Book), CCSDS A02.1-Y-4. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, April 2014.
- [C2] *Overview of Space Communications Protocols*. Issue 4. Report Concerning Space Data System Standards (Green Book), CCSDS 130.0-G-4. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, April 2023.
- [C3] *Space Communications Cross Support—Architecture Description Document*. Issue 1. Report Concerning Space Data System Standards (Green Book), CCSDS 901.0-G-1. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, November 2013.
- [C4] *Space Communications Cross Support—Architecture Requirements Document*. Issue 1. Recommendation for Space Data System Practices (Magenta Book), CCSDS 901.1-M-1. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, May 2015.
- [C5] *Cross Support Concept—Part 1: Space Link Extension Services*. Issue 2. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 910.3-G-3. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, March 2006.
- [C6] *TC Space Data Link Protocol*. Issue 4. Recommendation for Space Data System Standards (Blue Book), CCSDS 232.0-B-4. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, October 2021.
- [C7] *The Application of Security to CCSDS Protocols*. Issue 3. Report Concerning Space Data System Standards (Green Book), CCSDS 350.0-G-3. Washington, D.C.: CCSDS, March 2019.

NOTE — Normative references are listed in 1.7.

ANNEX D

ONLY IDLE DATA FRAME RANDOMIZATION IMPLEMENTATION
OPTIONS

(INFORMATIVE)

Two possible implementations of the OID Frame Randomizer are shown in figures D-1 and D-2.

For each frame, the LFSRs are initialized at device start-up as follows:

- with an all-one seed when the generator in figure D-1 (Fibonacci form) is used; and
- with a '000000000011111111111111111101' seed when the generator in figure D-2 (Galois form) is used.

In both cases LFSRs are not restarted for subsequent OID Transfer Frames.

The first 10 bytes of the OID data pattern, in hexadecimal, are:

FF FF FF FF 6D B6 D8 61 45 1F

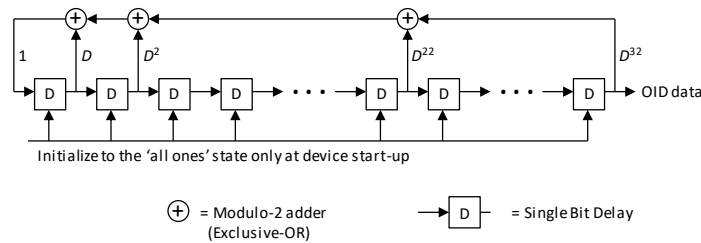


Figure D-1: OID Data Generation Logic Diagram (Fibonacci Form)

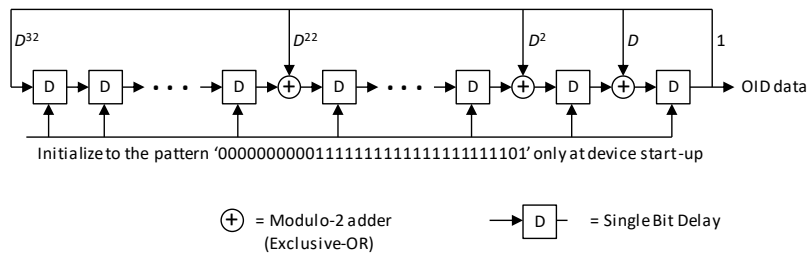


Figure D-2: OID Data Generation Logic Diagram (Galois Form)

Generated data pattern in both cases:

FF FF FF FF 6D B6 D8 61 45 1F 11 F1 97 16 72 3C BE 7E 00 B1 . . .